Reviewer Guidelines

Welcome to Project Odin!!

Project Odin is an exciting initiative at the frontier of AI development. The goal is to capture realistic, professional macOS workflows to help train and evaluate AI systems. The recordings show how professionals use applications, menus, and system features to complete meaningful work.

These recordings help train and evaluate AI systems by showing **how real users interact with applications, menus, and macOS system behaviors**.

Your Role

Review tasks to ensure they meet Odin quality guidelines.

Before you start

- New reviewers: complete the onboarding in the New Reviewers section of the Canvas pinned in #odin-reviewers-hub. **You will not have Studio access to start live reviews until you have completed onboarding and passed the reviewer screening quiz.**
- Run Insightful while doing onboarding (reading the guidelines, going to an onboarding call, and taking the quiz).
- **Device:** Reviewers don't need a Mac. Reviews are done in Studio through your browser, on Mac or Windows. (Writers record on macOS, so you'll need a Mac only if you also want to write tasks)
- Writing tasks as a reviewer promoted from writer: when the review queue is empty, you are expected to write tasks. Keep your Insightful timer running while you write. You stay on your hourly rate and your hourly bonuses still apply; writer bonuses (per-task, sprint and boost) do not. See the Oct 15 announcement in #odin--announcements.
- The Writer Guide covers what writers are told, particularly the Task Ideation and Studio Workflow pages. Its Payments and FAQ tabs explain the October 21 writer pay model. This writer-policy reference does not change the reviewer-specific compensation rules above.

The Reviewer Assessment

You are required to pass the reviewer assessment to become a reviewer on Project Odin. You will be provisioned access to all the relevant tooling for this project when you pass the reviewer assessment.

Claiming and completing reviews

- Finish each review in one sitting where possible. Finish each review in one sitting where possible. If you need more time, check in with an EPM, then select Extend Review Claim on the right of the task page.
    - If you need more time, **check in with an EPM**, then select **Extend Review Claim** on the right of the task page.
- **Found a critical issue? Take ~10 more minutes to catch other critical issues, then send back with the template.**

Send-backs and rejections

- **Restricted apps in tasks already in flight:**
    - **In review, and Pages in the setup (or other restricted app) is the only issue:** Pause the review, add internal note and note the task ID in the restricted-app tracking sheet. Do not reject and do not approve the task if Pages in the setup **(or other restricted app)** is the only issue. Leave the task as it is. **Contact an EPM.**
    - **Task idea approved with a restricted app but not recorded yet:** Ask the writer to change the app, and update the change for writers.(Changing the app is only possible in the Full Production world)
    - **In review, with other issues and a restricted app:** Send the task back for revisions (Full Production world) or reject it (Core world) and ask the writer to replace the restricted app.
    - **Already approved:** Note the task ID.
    - **Already rejected:** No action needed.

Reviewer Expectations

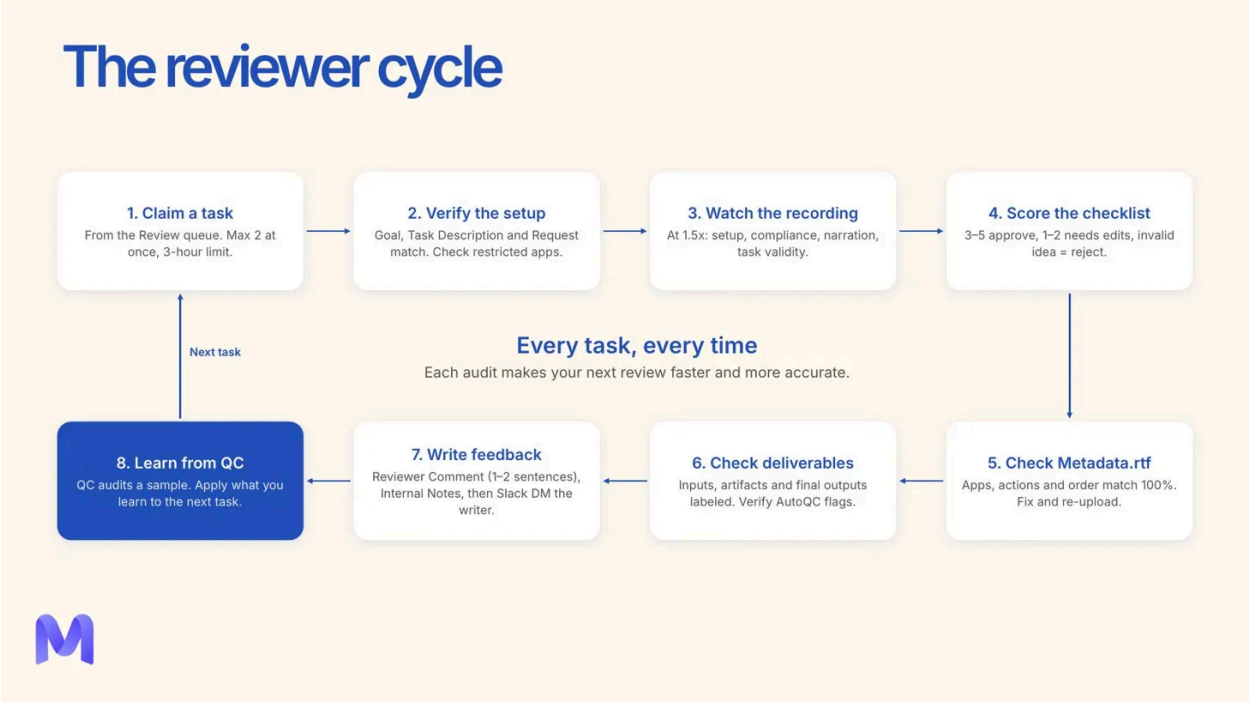
These expectations apply to **all reviewers**. Your metrics inform your reviewer status, including promotion and demotion. **You are responsible for maintaining these metrics.**

- **Audit defect rate: under 10%**
    - Fewer than 10% of your audited reviews (approvals and send-backs) should have QC defects.
    - **Follow the Reviewer Checklist on every task** to keep your defect rate low.
- **Review pass rate: 30% or higher**
    - At least 30% of the tasks you review should be approved by you.
    - **20% to under 30%:** this is a warning for now.
    - **Help train writers up:** give clear, specific feedback in your Reviewer Comments and Slack DM so writers can fix every issue in one pass and improve on their next task.
- **Review AHT: an average, not a per-review limit**

    - Keep AHT **under 45 minutes on average**. Individual reviews can take longer; maintain quality, and complete all required checks.
- **Hours per week: 15 hours**
    - Plan to spend 15 hours per week on reviews.
    -

Review Process

[Review Setup](#)
- [Live List of Restricted Apps](#)
- [Metadata.rtf Check](#)
- [Video Review](#)
- [Post-Video Review](#)



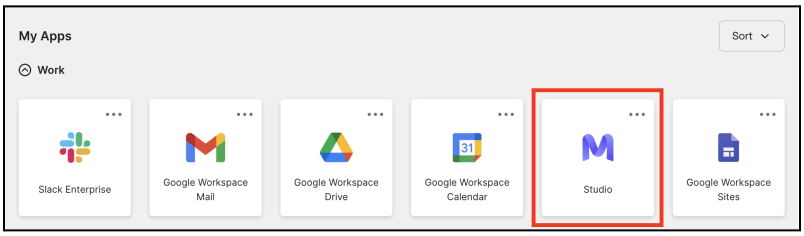
How to use this document

Read through this document from start to finish to understand the entire review process. Use it as a reference during your initial reviews to build strong habits and attention to detail. As you become more comfortable with the workflow, work to decrease your average handling time (AHT) while maintaining quality and precision.

Review Setup

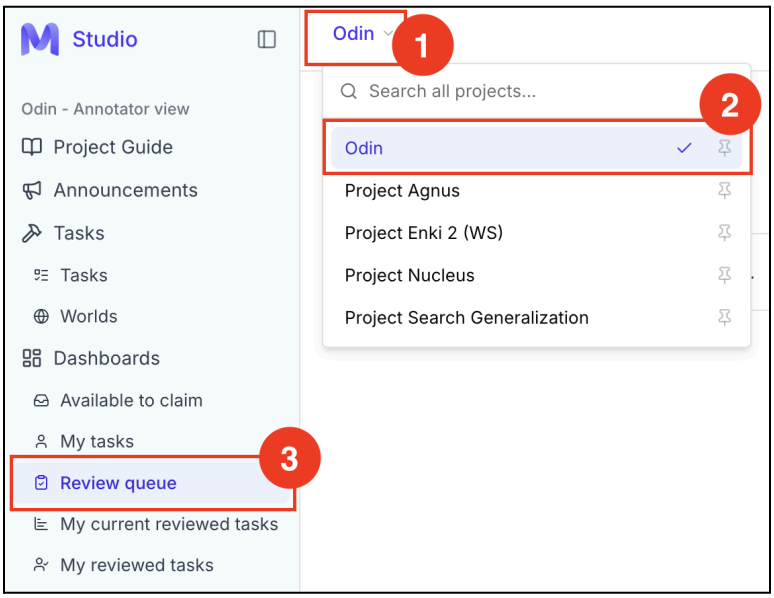
1. Claim a Task

- Access Studio through Okta



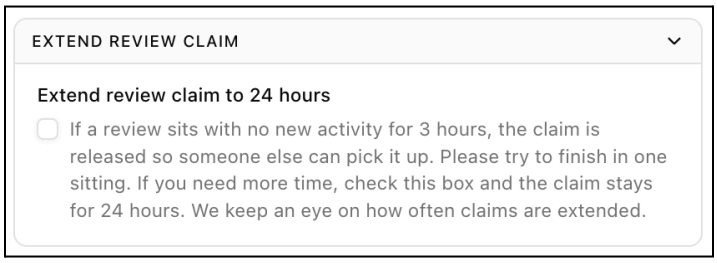
Do not use VPN - Sign-ins to Okta through a VPN, proxy, or other anonymizing network are blocked and show a 403 Access Forbidden error before the sign-in page loads. Turn off any VPN (system-wide app or browser extension) before starting the Okta setup and whenever you sign in to Okta. See the Account Security and Conduct policy.

- In Studio, click the **Project Selector** at the top, and select the Project Odin Studio space. Then, from the left-side navigation menu, under **Dashboards**, select **Review queue**



- Select and then claim a task; prioritize (click on the column header to sort):
  - First submission
  - Longest time in the queue
- You can also set the **Filter** to see tasks currently awaiting review.
- **Do not have more than 2 reviews claimed at a time.**
- **Finish in one sitting:**
  - Please try to finish your review in one sitting.

- If you need more time, check in with an EPM and extend the claim rather than letting it lapse.
    - If you need an extension, **please check in with one of the EPMs** and then select **the Extend Review Claim** box on the right of the task page.



Restricted vs. Allowed Apps

Restricted apps in existing recordings: Complete the review. If a restricted app is the only issue, including in the opening Goal document, do not approve or reject the task. Add an Internal Note explaining the app and its use, add the task ID to the restricted-app tracking sheet, unclaim the task, and contact an EPM for a decision. If other issues require revisions or rejection, follow the existing send-back rules and ask the writer to replace the restricted app.

App eligibility: The approved-app requirement is retired. Unrestricted apps may be used without prior approval. Do not fail or hold a task solely because its app is unlisted or lacks prior app approval. Follow the canonical three-category app list at https://odin-mercor1.vercel.app/validated-apps. **It governs when older Studio labels or copied tables disagree.**

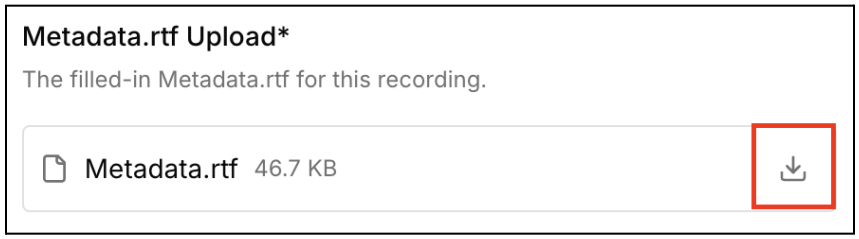
Project operating rule: minimal use means less than 20% of the task. Workpuls/Insightful and Splashtop Streamer remain background-only, and app-specific supporting-use limits still apply. Apply the 2026-10-16 18:08 PDT cutoff and in-flight protection stated there; now-allowed app rejections may be reconsidered subject to other quality checks. Only Notes.app and TextEdit cannot be used to display the opening Goal document; Preview and other apps are fine. Notes remain allowed but discouraged for genuine task work. The table below is historical; check the current category for each app.

What to verify

- These must match each other exactly:
    - Goal in the Studio Prompt/Description
    - Task Description in the TaskRecorder window and metadata.json
    - TaskRecorder 2.4.4 requires no sign-in, so its metadata.json google_account field may be empty.
    - Request section in metadata.rtf
- Writers and reviewers can't edit the Studio Prompt/Description field.
- If the Metadata.rtf file is incorrect and does not match the Task Recorder, **reviewers are expected to edit it - you will be warned if you fail to do this**
- An approved idea creates the task automatically, so you don't need to check whether the idea was approved first.
- To get live captions on recordings (Chrome only):
    - Click the ... in the top right of Chrome and select Settings.
    - On the left sidebar, select Accessibility.
    - Turn on Live Caption and make sure the language is English.
    - In Studio, click the download button on the recording to open it in a new tab. Captions appear during playback.
        - See the Slack thread for screenshots.

Metadata.rtf Check

- Click and download the **Metadata.rtf** from the **Task files** section in Studio



- Once it's downloaded and saved to your computer, click and open it in TextEdit.app
    - Open it in any text editor (TextEdit on Mac; WordPad or Word on Windows). Keep the file in .rtf format.
- As you review, pull up the task's **Metadata.rtf file** and make sure that the apps, actions, and chronology sync up 100% to the recording and the Task Description. If they do not match → **Reviewer makes edits and re-uploads**

Topology

- Topology is a high-level overview of the chronological sequence/workflow shown in the recording
- There are ONLY 3 categories allowed in ***topology:***

    - **1.**LOOKUP **2.**CREATE **3.**MODIFY
- Apps can be repeated in the flow if they are used more than once
    - Examples:
        - Finder (LOOKUP) -> Note (CREATE) -> Chrome (LOOKUP) -> LibreOffice Impress (CREATE) →> Chrome (LOOKUP) -> LibreOffice Impress (MODIFY)
        - Safari (LOOKUP) -> Microsoft Excel (CREATE) -> GraphPad Prism (CREATE)

Category	Meaning	Example
LOOKUP	Reading or finding information without changing anything	Finder (LOOKUP): searching for a file Chrome (LOOKUP): reading a reference page
CREATE	Making something that didn't exist before	Note (CREATE): writing a new note Microsoft Excel (CREATE): building a new spreadsheet
MODIFY	Changing something that already exists	LibreOffice Impress (MODIFY): editing slides made earlier in the task

Request

- Should be the same as the **Goal** section in the **Studio Prompt/Description**.
    - For example: I've approved the talking points for next week's meeting. Go ahead and make a slide deck that highlights the pros and cons of opening a restaurant in Midwest City, Oklahoma. Make sure to include demographic data and actual photos of the area — not stock images.

Task Description

- A numbered step-by-step outline of how the writer will complete the task.

Video Review

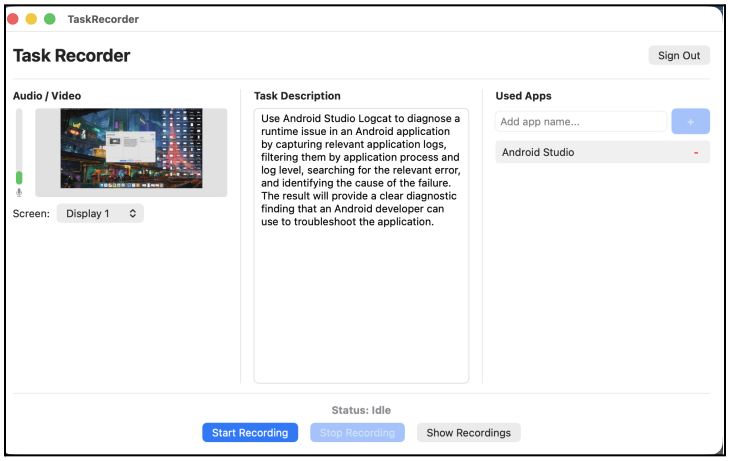
- Reviewer acceptance: the total recording, including the short intro and epilogue, must be at least 15 minutes and no more than 54 minutes and 59 seconds (15:00-54:59). Writer guidance remains 15:00 to 50:59. Do not reject or request re-recording solely because a video is over 50:59 but no more than 54:59; all other quality requirements still apply.
- A single-app task is acceptable; there is no minimum app count. Using multiple apps is encouraged when each contributes substantively and meaningfully to the task.
    - Every task, regardless of app count, must reflect a realistic professional workflow within the domain of expertise, demonstrate meaningful skill and judgment, and result in a clear deliverable.

Note: *Recordings should be reviewed at x1.5 speed.*

Setup/Intro Review

- Recording starts with the **TaskRecorder** window shown.
    - If the TaskRecorder window is not shown at the beginning of the recording, this might be a TR bug → **Review as normal and include in the internal notes**
    - **TaskRecorder** window minimized at the beginning of recording]

- **Task Description** and **Used Apps** are already filled out in the TaskRecorder screen at the beginning of the recording, and the description matches the Studio (Goal section) and the Task Description document (Goal section).



- **Menu bar & Dock:**
    - **Menu bar:** the clock on the menu bar should display seconds (HH:MM:SS).
    - **Dock:** Visible at least at the beginning and the end of recording, with the **Accessibility Inspector** opened in the dock with a dot at the bottom.

- **UI Diversity:**

- **At least one element must be changed to create a diverse desktop environment:**
  - dark vs light mode
  - dock position
  - colors
  - resolutions
  - wallpaper
  - size of icon
  - theme
- Mouse cursor size and color must stay default.

Intro Steps the writer follows

1. Desktop setup (opening apps, changing UI elements, etc.) and draft the task description document
2. Minimize all apps to the dock
3. Leave the task description document open on screen
4. Open the TR window and click **Start Recording**
5. Minimizing TR window
6. Narrate “I will be beginning my task soon. Here is the workflow I have in mind.” - Similar sentences are ok and do not block approval
7. Wait a few seconds
8. Minimize task description
9. This marks the start of the task

Task Review

- **App usage:**
  - A single-app task is acceptable. Do not request extra apps solely to reach an app count. Assess the professional workflow, skill, judgment, and deliverable requirements above.
  - Apps used during the tasks must match those listed in Studio.
  - Do not list the browser when it’s only used to open web apps (e.g., Google Docs in Opera). List the web apps themselves. A browser is listed only when it’s used as an app in its own right.
  - All listed apps need to provide meaningful contribution to the deliverable; meaningful work must be performed in all of the apps.
    - **For example:** If copying text from GDoc to Pages, this is not meaningful.
  - The notes app used in setup should not be listed in the AT unless used during the task.

- **AI Use:**
  - No AI tool or AI Mode interaction in the task is allowed
    - Use AI-generated input files → **Allowed**

        - Interacting with any type of AI or using AI to generate content during recording → **Not Allowed**
        - **Google interaction:**
            1. Looking at AI Overview search results or clicking **Show more** → **Allowed**
            2. **Interacting/communicating/chatting** with **Ask Anything** (for instance, asking a prompt in Ask Anything) → **Not Allowed**
        - Passive enhancement / ordinary built-in functionality → **Allowed**

- **PII & Copyrights:**
    - No personal accounts used or personal information shown.
    - Project information alone does not block approval. Continue checking independently for PII and other blocking issues.
    - Only use CC0/Public Domain images and files.
    - Input files should also be PII-free, royalty-free, and have no copyright information (CC0).
    - See the PII and Royalty-free Issues page for more details.

- **Mouse movement:**
    - The mouse should be continuously moving most of the time.
        - Typing doesn't count as mouse movement; the cursor should not be idle for >45s in an instance outside the closing epilogue. The epilogue may be still. AutoQC excludes the final 5 minutes from its mouse-idle check; this technical buffer does not increase the 4-minute epilogue maximum.
        - **Tasks should never be rejected for mouse inactivity alone unless it is >40% of the recording**
    - Most actions should use the mouse rather than the keyboard. Typing fails when it takes up over 25% of the total recording time, or over 35% for Coding / Content & Writing tasks. Exactly 25% (35% for Coding / Content & Writing) does not fail this item.
    - Clicks should be deliberate and unrushed.

- **Audio: See detailed instructions on Audio Guidance here**
    - **Narration** should be from the Intro through the end of the recording.
        - Natural, clear, and aligned narration of actions and thought process.
        - No major pauses.
        - **Narration cadence, workflow actions, and interactions** should not be rushed.
        - Must follow the What, Where, Why criteria.
            1. No **"this", "that", or "here".**
                - ❌ Bad Examples:
                    - I'll click on this button
                    - I need to change that value.

        - ✅ Good Examples:
            - I'll click the blue Export button in the top right corner.
            - I need to change the font size, which is currently set to 12.
    - **Background noise obscuring 30–40% of the narration = option 2. Option 3 = N/A. Over 40% of the narration = option 4. Loud typing is acceptable if narration remains clear.**

- **Window Management:**
    - Writers should use the available screen space effectively. When possible, maximize application windows or arrange them side by side.
    - Writers should work to cover the desktop background. Small floating windows are not preferred.
    - **Side-by-side** window arrangement is encouraged
    - If more than **~25% of a window or application** is covered by other windows/apps, it should be minimized within 6 seconds.
        - ***Exception:*** *Slight delays are allowed if the writer clearly notices the overlap immediately and makes a dedicated, immediate effort to fix it (e.g. they are narrating while minimizing the window or moving the mouse slowly).*
    - Windows important for the task and the current sub-task can remain un-minimized if they are clearly visible and logically arranged.
    - **In-app Popups:** Temporary popups or dialogs within the same application are allowed while actively used. They should be closed afterward.

- **English is required as the primary language.** Narration, deliverables, webpages, and app menus must all be in English

- **NEW - Epilogue narration (ideas originally approved at or after Oct 19, 2026, 6PM PT)**
    - For Full Workflow, ideas originally approved before October 19, 2026, 6 pm PT (PDT) remain exempt from the epilogue, including after later revision or reapproval. Writers still tick the epilogue checkbox to confirm either a completed required epilogue or the pre-cutoff exemption; they must not tick it if neither condition is true. **For the time being, do not fail, send back, or require re-recording solely because an epilogue is missing, regardless of idea approval date.** This manual checkbox is separate from AutoQC: assess written disputes using the task and relevant timestamps. If submission remains blocked, ask the writer to send the task link and exact error to #odin--helpdesk. After the task is finished and before the writer closes the task recorder, they must provide a brief summary of their work (target: 3-4 minutes; maximum: 4:00; no 3-minute

minimum), an assessment of whether the task was completed, any relevant reflections, or other important highlights: Possible topics include:

- **Completion and outcome:** How did you verify the successful completion of the task? Were there any limitations?
- **Approach and key decision:** What was your overall approach? Why did you choose this approach?
- **Challenges and problem solving:** What was the most difficult, ambiguous, or unexpected part? Did you encounter any errors or need to change your approach? How did you resolve the issue?
- **Quality assessment:** How would you evaluate the quality of your final result? Ar there any weaknesses or potential issues with the result?
- **Reflection and improvement**: If you were to do the task again, what would you do differently? If you had additional time, what would you improve or verify?
- **Insight:** What is one important principle, consideration, or common mistake that someone less experienced might overlook when performing this type of task?
- **Mouse is permitted to remain idle during the epilogue narration**

Post-Video Review

- **Download and verify Deliverables.zip files match the recording:**
    - Everything below needs to be included in the deliverable.zip:
        - **Input File:** Any original starting files prepared in advance(e.g., file, image, etc.); the original and unedited files are clearly labeled using the format: 'input 1', 'input 2', etc.
        - Websites the writer only visits for research or context (e.g., reading documentation, looking up reference data) are not input files. Don't fail a task for not including them in deliverable.zip or Final Notes.
        - **Intermediate Artifacts:** Any files downloaded during recording, intermediate deliverables, or work-in-progress artifacts created during the task must be clearly labeled using the format: 'artifact 1', 'artifact 2', etc.
        - **Final Output:** The final product produced by the expert, clearly labeled as 'final output 1', 'final output 2', etc.
    - **Example:** If a writer prepared a photo in advance, edited the photo using PhotoPea, and added the photo to create a slide, they will include the following in the deliverable.zip:
        - Unedited/original photo → input 1
        - Edited photo → artifact 1
        - Slide → final output 1

- **Rate the writer** using the Reviewer Checklist.

- **Update Studio fields if needed:**
    - **If you need to change a task field,** explain what needs to be changed and why. Include this in the **Reviewer Comments** and as an **Internal Note**.

- **Add Internal Notes**: *These are notes that the writers will not see. They are for QC and EPMs only.*
    - Add anything that you want to pass to QC, any minor issues that you find which do not affect approval, and/or any strengths in the task that override the minor issues.
    - Pro tip: If you find yourself making a judgment call on an edge case, explain your reasoning for approving the task in the Internal Notes.

- **Add Reviewer Comments:** *These are notes that are writer-facing and should reflect the DM that you send them.*
    - Please use this template at the top of every review. Always put your most recent review of the task at the top.
        - MM/DD @ HH:MM TIMEZONE, Review #_____, REVIEWER NAME

Decide if the Task is Approved or Request Edits

Approve: If a 3-5 is selected for a task, it is approved.

- 4-5 = Approvable as submitted (No 3s or 4s)
    - Excellent = Approvable as submitted (No 3s or 4s)
    - Good, but writer needs some tips = Lower quality, but likely useful (a couple of 3, but no 4s)
- 3 = Lower quality, but likely useful (No 4s)
    - Edge Case = Some 2s and 3s but no 4's.

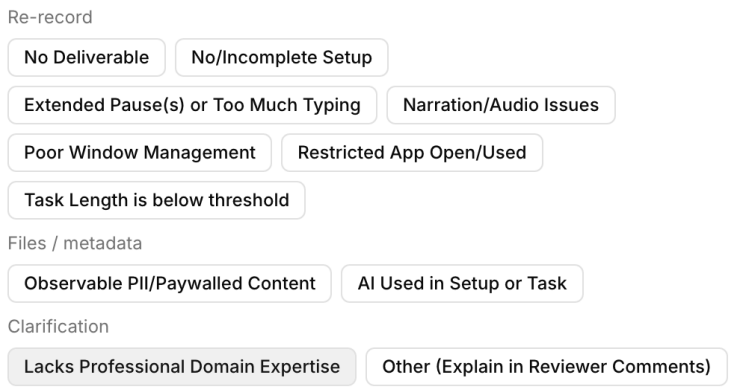
Needs Edits: If a 1-2 is selected, it is sent back to the writer for revisions.

- 2 = Needs revisions
    - Fair = Mostly 3s and at least one 4; Needs Revision.
- 1 = Needs revisions, task not salvageable
    - Poor = Mostly 3s and 4s, Needs Revision.

QUALITY CLARIFICATION: DO NOT send tasks back solely because pauses after clicks are shorter than one second. The exact threshold is under review. Continue assessing pacing and followability using the existing review standards.

Needs edit reason

If the task is being sent back for revisions, you will be asked to select every reason from the following reasons why:



Feedback field

IMPORTANT!

At the very end, send a Slack DM of your feedback to the Writer. Use the DM Templates for each flag in the task.

These are visible to the writer and should be identical to the DM that you send them after you complete the review of the task.

- Begin each review comment with:
    - Review [#]: [MM/DD/YYY] @ [HH:MM TIMEZONE] Reviewer: [Name]

Always add the most recent comment at the top.

The goal for reviewers is to leave no more than 1-2 sentences of personalized feedback to writers, regardless of whether the task is failed or approved. Please take this opportunity to advise writers on how to improve, provide encouragement, or congratulate them on submitting great work.

Reviewer Checklist

Below is the Project Odin Reviewer checklist that will be used to verify the quality of tasks on Project Odin. When reviewing a task, you will be selecting which tolerance criteria have been met for each checklist item, which is on the following scale:

- 1 = Within client tolerance
- 2 = Within acceptable tolerance
- 3 = Within edge case tolerance
- 4 = Failing tolerance

Some checklist items have binary tolerance criteria - they either fulfilled it (1 = Yes) or they failed to meet it (4 = No). Other checklist items have a range which will be described within each checklist item.

Checklist item	**Criteria**			
	1 = Within client tolerance	**2 = Within acceptable tolerance**	**3 = Within edge case tolerance**	**4 = Failing tolerance**
1. [Automated but PLEASE manually check] Metadata.rtf matches the TaskRecorder Goal(apps, workflow)	Metadata.rtf matches the TaskRecorder Goal(apps, workflow)	Metadata.rtf >80% similar to the TaskRecorder Goal	Metadata.rtf >70% similar to the TaskRecorder Goal	Metadata.rtf <70% similar to the TaskRecorder Goal
2. [Automated but PLEASE manually check] No unused window covers >25% of another for >6 s	**No unused window covers >25% of another for >6 s**	A window covers >25% of another (or is entirely covered by the window in use) for 6-30s	N/A	A window covers >25% of another (or is entirely covered by the window in use) for >30s
3. [Automated but PLEASE manually check] Narration says what, where and why for every action	Yes	≥70% of actions have 2 of the 3 Ws	N/A	Under 70% of actions have at least 2 of the 3 Ws (an action is anything that changes the state of the document)
4. [Automated but PLEASE manually check]	Yes	≥70% of actions have 2 of the 3 Ws	N/A	Under 70% of actions have at

Checklist item	Criteria			
	1 = Within client tolerance	**2 = Within acceptable tolerance**	**3 = Within edge case tolerance**	**4 = Failing tolerance**
Eyes closed test: Viewer clearly understands what actions are being performed in the video with eyes closed (no 'click here', 'change this')				least 2 of the 3 Ws
5. [Automated but PLEASE manually check] Screen recording shows the workflow described in the task	Yes	N/A	N/A	No (Video performs multiple major actions not stated in the task or Video is missing multiple major actions not stated in the task)
6. [Automated but PLEASE manually check] The menu bar clock shows seconds.	Yes	N/A	N/A	No
7. [Automated but PLEASE manually check] The task description document is shown at the start of the recording.	Yes	N/A	N/A	No
8. [Manual] Intro is under 20 seconds: writer says the intro sentences, minimizes the Goal document, then starts.	Intro is under 20 seconds: writer says the intro sentences, minimizes the Goal document, then starts.	Intro is under 6-120 seconds: writer says the intro sentences, minimizes the Goal document, then starts.	N/A	Intro is under 120+ seconds: writer says the intro sentences, minimizes the Goal document, then starts.
9. [Automated but PLEASE manually check] Typing takes up 25% of the video or less (35% or less for Coding / Content & Writing tasks).	Typing takes up ≤25% of the video (≤35% for Coding / Content & Writing); does not fail.	N/A	N/A	No, typing takes up >25% of the video (>35% for Coding / Content & Writing).

Checklist item	Criteria			
	1 = Within client tolerance	**2 = Within acceptable tolerance**	**3 = Within edge case tolerance**	**4 = Failing tolerance**
10. [Automated but PLEASE manually check] Every silence lasts 45 seconds or less.	**Every silence lasts 45 seconds or less.**	**Every silence lasts 60 seconds or less.**	N/A	**1 or more silences last more than 60s**
11. [Automated but PLEASE manually check] The narration audio is clear, with no background noise making it hard to hear. (Exception: loud typing is fine as long as it does not make narration unclear.)	Background noise <30% of the narration	Background noise 30–40% of the narration	N/A	Background noise over 40% of the narration
12. [Manual] Writer's speech can be understood by a native listener without multiple replays / guessing	Writer's speech can be understood by a native listener without multiple replays / guessing	N/A	N/A	Writer's speech cannot be understood by a native listener without multiple replays / guessing
13. The writer is speaking at a normal pace that does not impede understanding / require multiple replays	The writer is speaking at a normal pace that does not impede understanding / require multiple replays	N/A	N/A	Writer is speaking at a pace that impedes understanding
14. [Manual] The writer pauses for at least 1 second after each mouse click (i.e. they don't click too fast)	The writer pauses for at least 1 second after each mouse click)	The writer pauses for at least 1 second after each mouse click 5-15 times	N/A	The writer pauses for at least 1 second after each mouse click 15+ times
15. [Manual] The recording is free of disallowed AI use. Ordinary incidental enhancement may be acceptable; substantive	Yes	No, Google AI Overview (no follow-ups), autocomplete, SWE/ML	N/A	No, AI interaction present

Checklist item	Criteria			
	1 = Within client tolerance	**2 = Within acceptable tolerance**	**3 = Within edge case tolerance**	**4 = Failing tolerance**
AI task tools are not automatically allowed. Follow the detailed AI guidance and escalate unclear cases.				
16. [Manual] The recording is free of personal information (PII), both on screen and in the audio. Check app account corners (Office, Google, browser profile), Finder and save-dialog paths, and the last few minutes. See the PII and Royalty-free Issues tab for real examples that slipped through.	Yes	N/A	N/A	No
17. [Manual] Deliverable assets meet the applicable licensing requirements. Apply the PII and Copyright Issues guidance, including public-repository exceptions; merely browsing a website with a trademarked logo does not fail.	Yes	N/A	N/A	No
18. [Manual] The narration and everything on screen are free of profanity.	Yes	Minor profanity on screen, not typed by the writer	N/A	Profanity said or typed by the writer, or major on-screen profanity
19. [Manual] Task is recorded in English and all task materials are in English	Yes	N/A	N/A	No/Cannot verify
20. [Manual] Recording includes an epilogue	Yes	No, narration length is between	No, the narration lacked	N/A

Checklist item	Criteria			
	1 = Within client tolerance	**2 = Within acceptable tolerance**	**3 = Within edge case tolerance**	**4 = Failing tolerance**
narration (a narrated summary of how the task was verified, the approach, challenges, quality, and reflections) of 4 minutes or less, before stopping recording (only for ideas originally approved at or after Oct 19, 2026 6PM PT). Target 3-4 minutes with no 3-minute minimum. All duration bands over 4:00 exceed the maximum; they record severity, not an allowance for extra duration. Additional unscored response: "Missing epilogue — does not block approval." Use this dedicated response for a missing epilogue rather than N/A; it must not count as a numeric failure. Do not fail, send back, or require re-recording solely because an epilogue is missing, regardless of idea approval date.		4:01-4:30 mins (exceeds the 4:00 maximum)	detail / length is 4:31+ mins (exceeds the 4:00 maximum)	

AutoQC checks of task elements (for reference purpose):

These checks have been removed from the checklist as AutoQC has enough precision and recall to identify these issues. **HOWEVER, if you do see a mismatch between an AutoQC flag and one of these items, please flag it in your review feedback. You may send back tasks for violations of these items.**

1. All four task files uploaded (MP4, deliverables.zip, Task Recorder zip, Metadata.rtf)
2. Task Recorder zip contents complete, screenshots present
3. video.mp4 opens
4. Deliverables named correctly
5. Metadata.rtf matches the task (apps, workflow)
6. Video length within 15 to 54:59 minutes
7. Dock stays visible (not covered) in the start and end of recording
8. No unused window covers >25% of another for >6 s
    a. **Major flag:** Unused window covers >25% of a task for >30s
    b. **Minor flag:** Unused window covers >25% of a task for 6-30s
9. Mouse never idle >45 s
    a. **Major flag:** Mouse idle for >90s
    b. **Minor flag:** Mouse idle for ≥3 stretches within 45–90s
10. Narration says what, where and why for every action
11. Narration names what and where, no 'click here' / 'change this'
12. Screen recording shows the workflow described in the task
13. Metadata.rtf apps match the apps listed in Studio
14. Accessibility Inspector icon is visible in the Dock with a dot underneath
15. Accessibility Inspector window is not visible during the recording (exception: first-time writers)
16. At least 1 UI element has been changed from the default Mac setup
17. The task contains zero use of restricted apps
18. Narration cadence and workflow interactions are followable at normal speed

PII and Copyright Issues

No PII (Personally Identifiable Information) should be visible during the recording of the task, including in any of the input files:

Any information that can identify a real person, such as:

- Writer's full names
- email addresses
- phone numbers
- home addresses
- account numbers
- biometrics
- Mac Address
- etc.

Where reviewers most often miss PII (4 send-backs on Oct 19-20):

• A writer's name and profile photo in PowerPoint's account area (top right) at 22:10.

• A writer's full name on screen at 34:59, near the end of the recording.

• A username visible in a Finder path at 5:03.

• A personal Chrome login with the profile photo showing in the top right of the browser.

How to check quickly: scrub to the start, every app switch, every save or export dialog, and the last few minutes, and look at the top-right corner of each app window and the Finder sidebar each time. A single frame with a real name, photo or personal email is a send-back.

Edge cases:

- If the full name is of a public figure → **OK**
- If the full name is not combined with any other information that can increase the specificity → **OK**
    - Sandy Jones (alone) → **OK**
    - sandyjones@walmart.com → **PII** (identifies a person + company)
    - sandyjones@example.com → **Not PII** (example domain / not meaningfully identifying)
- If the name/email/phone number is obviously made up and fake, e.g. John Smith or johnsmith@example.com or 123-456-7890 → **OK**
- @mercor.expert account names → OK
- IP addresses → **OK**
- Mac Serial Number (found in the *Hardware Overview* page in *System Information.app*):

    - Standalone MAC serial numbers → **OK**
    - MAC serial number **PLUS** IPV6 → **PII**
- If you are unsure whether something is a PII issue, post in #odin-reviewers-hub.

@mercor.expert emails, or obviously fake name/email/phone numbers, are allowed. (Assigned OTA accounts are retired; TaskRecorder 2.4.4 has no sign-in.)

EXCEPTIONS: Public profiles such as authors of publications or GitHub users from public GitHub repositories do not count as PII.

SWE/ML/DS tracks: Public Repositories Exception: Currently, the exception to the rule is for tasks involving gitflow, where the task involves pulling repositories from GitHub. Despite this, only public repositories are allowed; even then, steer toward repositories with MIT, BSD, Apache 2.0, CC0, public domain, ODC-by, or PDDL licenses, as these licenses are widely considered compliant under copyright laws. Licenses are typically found in the repository root or in README.md, under names like LICENSE.md/LICENSE.txt or COPYING.txt.

CC0/Public Domain Only: If the task requires downloading images, videos, or assets, ensure they are under CC0 license or in the Public Domain.

This only applies to information that ends up in the Deliverable.zip. Browsing a website with a trademarked logo is acceptable.

- **Copyright:** a clear watermark (**exception: Gemini watermark**) or copyright logo → reject, unless it is CC0. Escalate to EPM if unsure.

Note: Please do not recommend a website to a writer unless you are 100% certain its content is under CC0 or its Terms & Conditions allow AI/ML training.

Search & AI (and how to distinguish cases):

- Google Search only, including links in the AI overview, even in “Show more,” but **no** interaction with AI Overview “Ask anything”, **is allowed.**
- Generative/conversational AI → **Request Edits**.
    - Any prompting, chatting, follow-up question, AI Mode, Gemini/ChatGPT/Claude use, Google AI Overview “Ask anything,” or AI-generated task content during setup/task recording is not allowed.
- AI-powered task tools → **Request Edits.**
    - If an app feature uses AI/ML to perform substantive task work, such as identifying a subject, selecting/masking an object, generating text/images, summarizing, classifying, etc, request edits.
    - Example: Photoshop subject identification used to create/edit the deliverable.
- Passive enhancement / ordinary built-in functionality → **Escalate if unclear; may be acceptable**.

    - If the feature is not presented as AI, involves no prompting/generative AI, and only performs incidental quality cleanup rather than substantive task work, it may be acceptable.
    - Example: Voice Memos Enhance Recording was treated as an edge-case exception when no AI agent interaction occurred, and the task was otherwise strong. Escalate similar cases before rejecting.
- SWE/ML/AI exceptions → **Acceptable/Escalate if unclear**
    - For SWE tasks, writers may use code that includes an AI/ML component (such as building foundation models). Running the code may be acceptable **only if** it is part of normal SWE validation and not being used as an external assistant to complete the task.
    - Escalate ambiguous cases.
    -

Audio-specific Guidance

Narration must include thought process and actions (i.e., mouse movements, clicks, and scrolling, step by step)

Pacing and Audio Quality

- **Avoid Rushing** - Ensure all clicks and actions are narrated at a deliberate, measured pace. Workflows and mouse interactions should be in sync with narration. Rule of thumb: if you need to slow the video down to .75x speed, or pause and rewind for more than 30% of the recording, it is rushed.
- **Audio Environment** - Ensure there is no background noise when recording audio. Ideally, use headphones with a dedicated microphone when available to maintain clear audio quality.
- **Pause After Clicks** - Experts should wait 1 second after clicking on something.

Narration is trying to meet 3 criteria:

1. **What** - What physical action produces the interaction (scroll, right-click, left-click)?
2. **Where** - Where on the screen does the interaction take place (top left, bottom right, left panel)?
3. **Why** - Why is this interaction important? What does the interaction do (closes the app, saves the doc, etc.)?

Common Pitfalls:

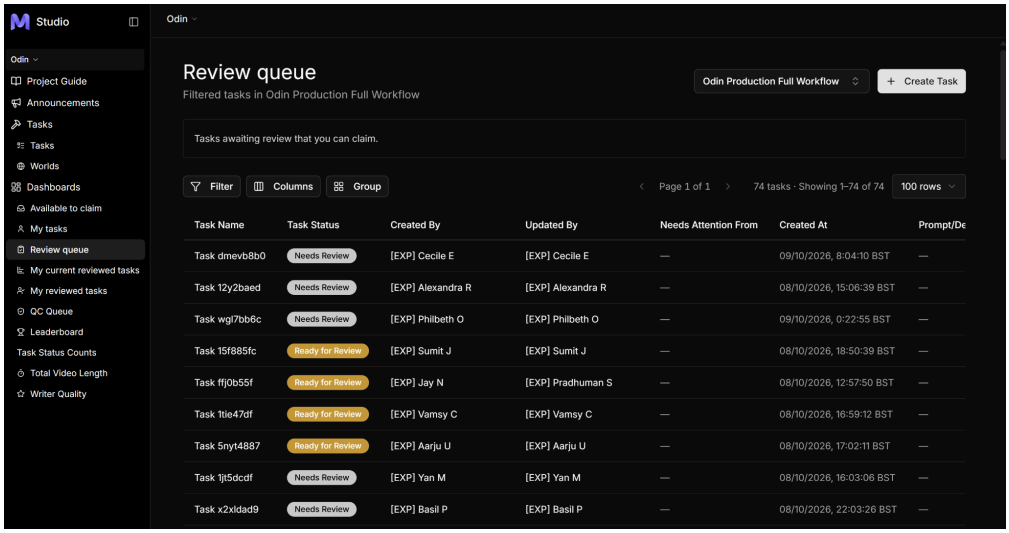
- Failing to narrate each major step of a workflow as it happens.
- Long introduction
- Long gaps without audio.
- No narration of shortcuts. All shortcuts used must provide keystrokes and resulting action.
- Narration that is difficult to hear/understand.
- Noise or audio distractions interfere with intelligibility.
- Referencing the task description verbatim. The task should be described naturally, as it happens.
- Golden narration is clear, concise, coherent, easy to understand, logically structured, and directly supports the steps being shown, while still allowing for a natural speaking style, such as natural pauses or conversational fillers.
- Note: Natural conversational fillers like “uh” or “um” are acceptable; the goal is simply to avoid extended, off-topic tangents.
-

Studio Idea review

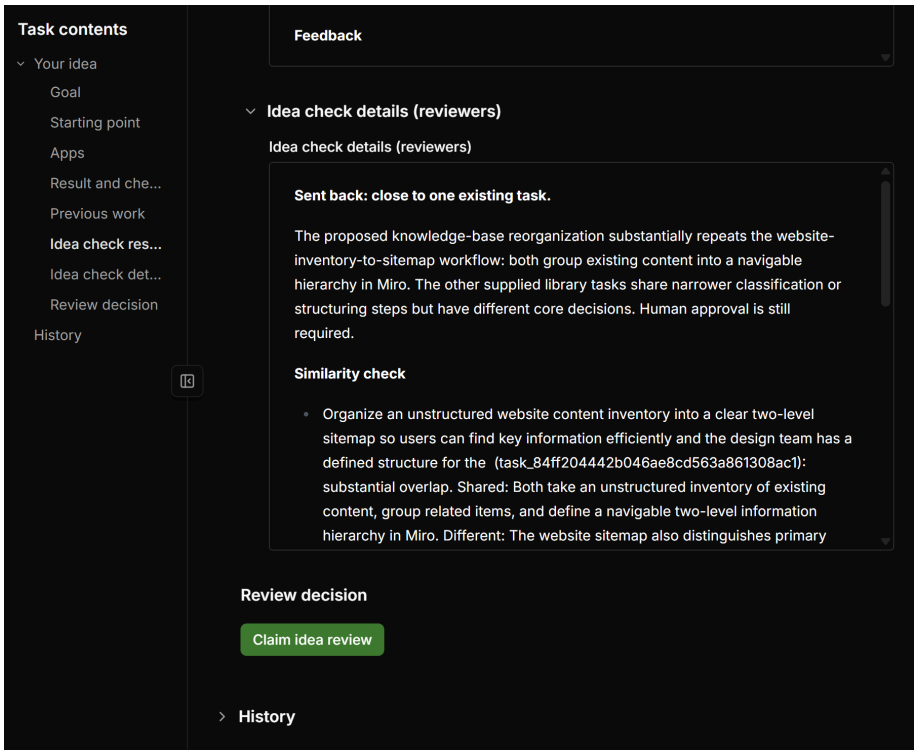
- Idea review is separate from task (recording) review.
- Idea reviews happen in Studio, in the **Odin Production Full Workflow** world.
- Idea checks are mostly automated. Distinct ideas are approved automatically so the writer can start recording.
- Ideas the model can't verify appear as **Needs Review** in the review queue.

  Watch a walkthrough video:
  https://mercor.enterprise.slack.com/files/U0AEX1WLK88/F0C815XMYG5/video.mp4

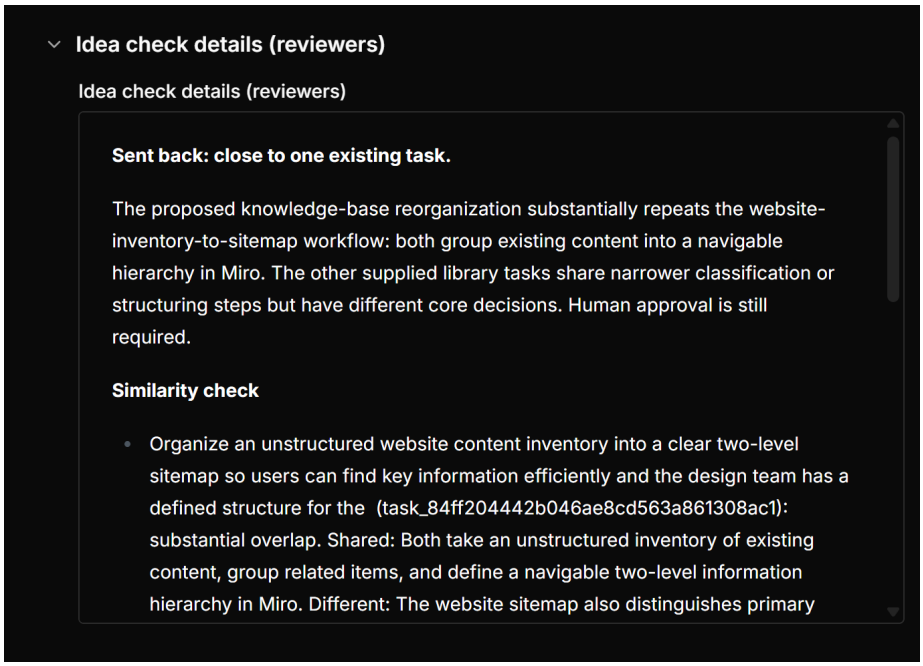
1. Head to the Review Queue in Studio and check if you have selected the **Odin Production Full Workflow** world in there.



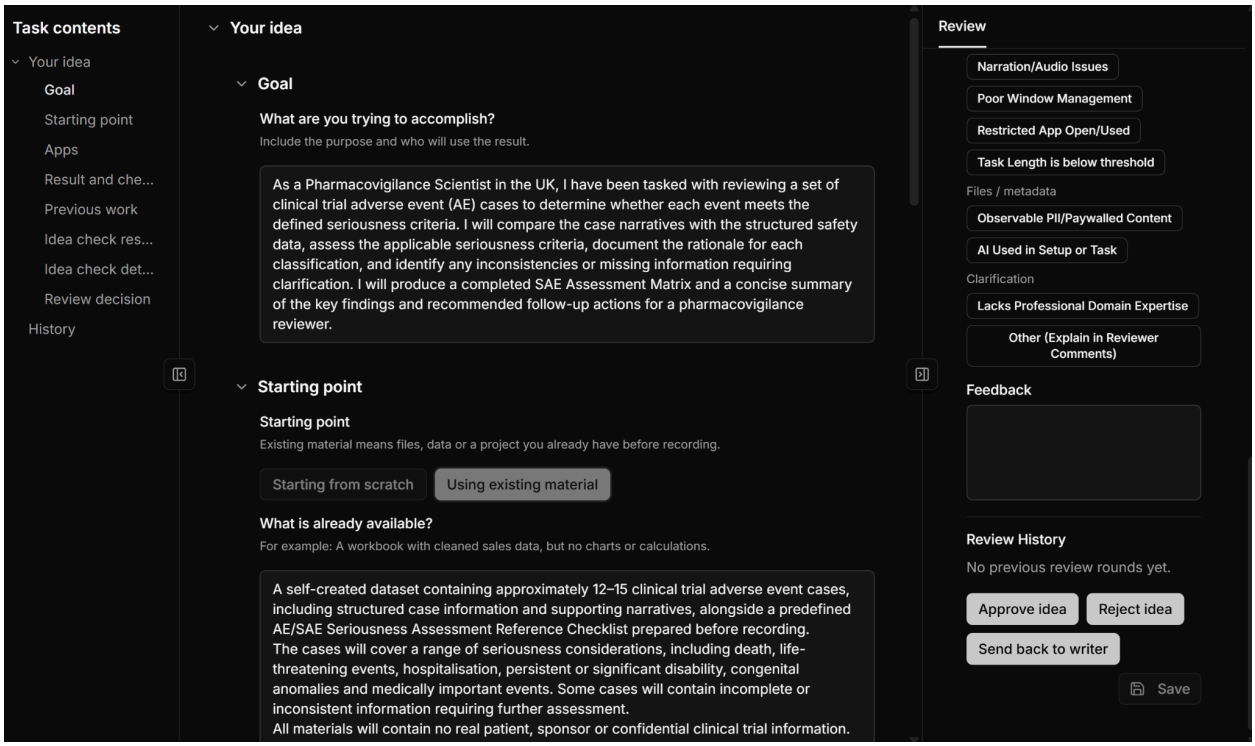
2. Look for the Task Status **‘Needs Review’**. Open the idea>claim idea review and skim-read through the goal, starting point, suggested apps, and reviews and checks.



3. Read through the results generated in the **Idea check details (reviewers)** section to compare the model’s findings to similar tasks in the project and check the same against the guidelines provided here**.**



4. Please complete the Idea review by adding your decision to the ‘Review’ panel to the left. Add feedback and either **Approve, Reject, or Send back to the Writer**.



QC auditor guidelines

Before you start

- Bookmark the QC Resources canvas. It has every link you need in one place.

Claiming and completing QC

- Finish each QC in one sitting where possible. Finish each QC in one sitting where possible. If you need more time, check in with an EPM, then select Extend Review Claim on the right of the task page. The QC AHT target is under 45 minutes on average per completed QC. Individual QCs can take longer when needed.
- QC AHT policy assessment uses the last seven complete Pacific calendar days (America/Los_Angeles), ending at midnight PT at the start of today and advancing daily. Calculate AHT as (eligible logged QC hours in that window × 60) ÷ completed QC decisions in the same window. Pool hours and decisions across all seven days; do not average daily AHTs. Dashboard display/report filters do not change the policy assessment window.
    - If you need more time, **check in with an EPM**, then select **Extend Review Claim** on the right of the task page.
- **Watch the full recording**, and judge followability at normal (1x) speed.
- **Complete the entire QC even if you know early that it's a send-back (DIFFERS FROM REVIEW FAST TRACK - QCers should complete the entire QC).** Complete the checklist thoroughly so the writer can fix it all in one pass.
- Leave feedback for the writer on every task, whether it is approved or sent back

What to check for reviewers

Along with the task itself, look over the reviewer's work.

- The reviewer completed every item on the Reviewer Checklist, and their answers match what you see in the recording.
- Every review comment is tied to checklist items, and the reviewer notes are clear and helpful. Comment is 1-2 sentences.
- Mistakes in Metadata.rtf were corrected, and the AutoQC results were validated.
    - If mistakes in the Metadata.rtf were not corrected - **you must correct it**
    - **Flag in the Internal Notes text box and DM them that they must complete this in the future**
- The send-back rules were followed (see QC rules to remember).

If you want to give the reviewer feedback, leave it in the Internal Notes text box or DM them. If you see the same reviewer missing the same thing more than once, flag it to an EPM.

QC rules to remember

- **The QC checklist is aligned to the reviewer checklist**
- If the recording differs from the Task Description or the app listed, and the task is otherwise approvable, note it in Internal Notes and approve.
- **If the reviewer missed a mistake in Metadata.rtf, correct it and re-upload the file.**
- **When you are unsure** (Narration, PII edge cases, passive AI features, SWE/ML exceptions), **escalate before you decide.** Post in the QC channel or check with an EPM.
- For the condition 'Narration says what, where and why for every action,' please align to the following condition:
    - **If the task contains ≥70% of 2 of the 3 of where, what, and why in its narration, IT IS APPROVABLE!!**

AutoQC checks

You are asked to verify various AQC flags on the task. For each flag, compare with the recording and make your assessment of what tolerance criteria it aligns with. If the writer disputed a flag, check their explanation against the recording and score what you see. Mention in your comment whether you agreed with the dispute.

Minor (advice) flags never block approval on their own. Score the checklist items as usual.

Possible AQC cards on the task:

Files and deliverables

- Metadata.rtf matches the task (apps, workflow): see checklist item 1.
    - Fails when Metadata.rtf is <70% similar to the TaskRecorder Goal or Studio.

Recording

- No unused window covers >25% of another for >6 s: see checklist item 2.
    - 6–30 s = option 2; over 30 s with no clear effort to fix within time = fail (4). If 6–30 s of overlap is the only issue, approve with a short growth note.
- Mouse never idle >45 s (no checklist item; score it here on the same ranges):
    - 1: never idle over 45 s.
    - 3: idle 45–60 s, one to three times.
    - 4: idle over 60 s at least once, or 45–60 s more than three times.
    - The closing epilogue is exempt.

Writer performance

- Narration says what, where, and why for every action: see checklist item 3.
    - Fails when under 70% of actions have at least 2 of the 3 Ws. An action is anything that changes the state of the document.
- Screen recording shows the workflow described in the task: see checklist item 5.

AutoQC checks of task elements (for reference purpose):

These checks have been removed from the checklist as AutoQC has enough precision and recall to identify these issues. **HOWEVER, if you do see a mismatch between an AutoQC flag and one of these items, please flag it in your review feedback. You may send back tasks for violations of these items.**

1. All four task files uploaded (MP4, deliverables.zip, Task Recorder zip, Metadata.rtf)
2. Task Recorder zip contents complete, screenshots present
3. video.mp4 opens
4. Deliverables named correctly
5. Metadata.rtf matches the task (apps, workflow)
6. Video length within 15 to 54:59 minutes
7. Dock stays visible (not covered) in the start and end of recording
8. No unused window covers >25% of another for >6 s
    a. **Major flag:** Unused window covers >25% of a task for >30s
    b. **Minor flag:** Unused window covers >25% of a task for 6-30s
9. Mouse never idle >45 s
    a. **Major flag:** Mouse idle for >90s
    b. **Minor flag:** Mouse idle for ≥3 stretches within 45–90s
10. Narration says what, where and why for every action
11. Narration names what and where, no 'click here' / 'change this'
12. Screen recording shows the workflow described in the task
13. Metadata.rtf apps match the apps listed in Studio
14. Accessibility Inspector icon is visible in the Dock with a dot underneath
15. Accessibility Inspector window is not visible during the recording (exception: first-time writers)
16. At least 1 UI element has been changed from the default Mac setup
17. The task contains zero use of restricted apps
18. Narration cadence and workflow interactions are followable at normal speed

Project Odin QC Auditor Checklist

Purpose

When reviewing a task, you select which tolerance criterion has been met for each checklist item.

Ask: *"For every item, which tolerance band does this recording actually sit in — and can I point at the moment that puts it there?"*

Where this sits

Read from the Odin Studio campaign on 20 Oct 2026. Confirm with an EPM before you rely on it if the flow has changed since.

Field	Value
World(s) in scope	Odin Production Core and Odin Production Full Workflow. Both run the same sampler and the same 21-item review form.
Status you audit at	Awaiting Final QC — the unclaimed pool. Claiming a task moves it to In QC Review. You leave it at QC Approved, Needs QC Revision or Rejected.
Audit sampling rate	20% of tasks. The sampler draws when a task reaches Review Approved. The other 80% go straight to Ready for Delivery and are never audited.
Where you record the bands	The Review checklist card on the task's review form. It has one field per item 1–21, then Writer's Quality Score and Feedback. Odin Production Full Workflow also has Needs edits reason.
AutoQC module	Two modules run on every task: Odin upload checks and Odin narration checks. Their flags are the AQC cards described above. Odin recording shows task check and Odin Eyes Closed check exist but are switched off.

How to audit

1. Work items 1–21 in order. For each item, select which tolerance criterion has been met.
2. Use the four-point scale: 1 = within client tolerance, 2 = within acceptable tolerance, 3 = within edge case tolerance, 4 = failing tolerance.
3. Some items are binary — they were either fulfilled (1 = Yes) or they failed to meet it (4 = No). The rest give a range, written into the item's own row.

4. Items 1–12 are automated, except item 8, which is manual. You are still asked to check them by hand, so do not score them from the automated result alone.
5. Cite a timestamp for every item you score at anything other than band 1, so the writer can find what you saw.
6. Please also refer to the AutoQC checks of task elements above - **if you see a mismatch between the AutoQC result and the recording, please flagt it in your reviewer feedback**

Ground rules

Rule	What it means
The four-point scale	1 = within client tolerance · 2 = within acceptable tolerance · 3 = within edge case tolerance · 4 = failing tolerance. Record a band for every item, not only the ones that go wrong.
Binary items	Some items have binary tolerance criteria — they either fulfilled it (1 = Yes) or they failed to meet it (4 = No). Those items read N/A in bands 2 and 3.
Range items	The rest give a range, and the range is written into that item's own row. Use the row, not your own judgement of how bad it looks.
No severity ranking	The guidelines grade by tolerance band only. They do not rank items as critical, major or minor, and this checklist does not add such a ranking.
Evidence	Cite the timestamp and the band you selected. "Item 11, band 4 — silence from 12:04 to 13:20", not "too much silence".
Not a defect	Loud typing, as long as it does not make the narration unclear (item 12). Ordinary incidental enhancement may be acceptable under the detailed AI guidance (item 15); substantive AI task tools are not automatically allowed, and unclear cases must be escalated. An epilogue under 3 minutes — item 20 sets a 4-minute maximum and no minimum.

Section 1 · Items 1–11 — mostly automated, but check them by hand

Every item here except 8 is labelled "Automated but PLEASE manually check". Item 8 is manual. A green automated result is never a band 1 on its own.

Checklist item	1 = Within client tolerance	2 = Within acceptable tolerance	3 = Within edge case tolerance	4 = Failing tolerance
1. [Automated but PLEASE manually check] Metadata.rtf matches the TaskRecorder Goal(apps, workflow)	Metadata.rtf matches the TaskRecorder Goal(apps, workflow)	Metadata.rtf >80% similar to the TaskRecorder Goal	Metadata.rtf >70% similar to the TaskRecorder Goal	Metadata.rtf <70% similar to the TaskRecorder Goal
2. [Automated but PLEASE manually check] No unused window covers >25% of another for >6 s	**No unused window covers >25% of another for >6 s**	A window covers >25% of another (or is entirely covered by the window in use) for 6-30s	N/A	A window covers >25% of another (or is entirely covered by the window in use) for >30s
3. [Automated but PLEASE manually check] Narration says what, where and why for every action	Yes	≥70% of actions have 2 of the 3 Ws	N/A	Under 70% of actions have at least 2 of the 3 Ws (an action is anything that changes the state of the document)
4. [Automated but PLEASE manually check] Eyes closed test: Viewer clearly understands what actions are being performed in the video with eyes closed (no 'click here', 'change this')	Yes	≥70% of actions have 2 of the 3 Ws	N/A	Under 70% of actions have at least 2 of the 3 Ws
5. [Automated but PLEASE manually check] Screen recording shows the workflow described in the task	Yes	N/A	N/A	No (Video performs multiple major actions not stated in the task or Video is missing multiple major actions not

Checklist item	1 = Within client tolerance	2 = Within acceptable tolerance	3 = Within edge case tolerance	4 = Failing tolerance
				stated in the task)
6. [Automated but PLEASE manually check] The menu bar clock shows seconds.	Yes	N/A	N/A	No
7. [Automated but PLEASE manually check] The task description document is shown at the start of the recording.	Yes	N/A	N/A	No
8. [Manual] Intro is under 20 seconds: writer says the intro sentences, minimizes the Goal document, then starts.	Intro is under 20 seconds: writer says the intro sentences, minimizes the Goal document, then starts.	Intro is under 6-120 seconds: writer says the intro sentences, minimizes the Goal document, then starts.	N/A	Intro is under 120+ seconds: writer says the intro sentences, minimizes the Goal document, then starts.
9. [Automated but PLEASE manually check] Typing takes up 25% of the video or less (35% or less for Coding / Content & Writing tasks).	Typing takes up ≤25% of the video (≤35% for Coding / Content & Writing); does not fail.	N/A	N/A	No, typing takes up >25% of the video (>35% for Coding / Content & Writing).
10. [Automated but PLEASE manually check] Every silence lasts 45 seconds or less.	**Every silence lasts 45 seconds or less.**	**Every silence lasts 60 seconds or less.**	N/A	**1 or more silences last more than 60s**
11. [Automated but PLEASE manually check] The narration audio is clear, with no background noise making it hard to hear. (Exception: loud typing	Background noise <30% of the narration	Background noise 30–40% of the narration	N/A	Background noise over 40% of the narration

Checklist item	1 = Within client tolerance	2 = Within acceptable tolerance	3 = Within edge case tolerance	4 = Failing tolerance
is fine as long as it does not make narration unclear.)				

Section 2 · Items 12–20 — manual checks

The guidelines label each of these "Manual". Nothing automated covers them.

Checklist item	1 = Within client tolerance	2 = Within acceptable tolerance	3 = Within edge case tolerance	4 = Failing tolerance
12. [Manual] Writer's speech can be understood by a native listener without multiple replays / guessing	Writer's speech can be understood by a native listener without multiple replays / guessing	N/A	N/A	Writer's speech cannot be understood by a native listener without multiple replays / guessing
13. The writer is speaking at a normal pace that does not impede understanding / require multiple replays	The writer is speaking at a normal pace that does not impede understanding / require multiple replays	N/A	N/A	Writer is speaking at a pace that impedes understanding
14. [Manual] The writer pauses for at least 1 second after each mouse click (i.e. they don't click too fast)	The writer pauses for at least 1 second after each mouse click)	The writer pauses for at least 1 second after each mouse click 5-15 times	N/A	The writer pauses for at least 1 second after each mouse click 15+ times
15. [Manual] The recording is free of disallowed AI use. Ordinary incidental enhancement may be	Yes	No, Google AI Overview (no follow-ups), autocomplete, SWE/ML	N/A	No, AI interaction present

Checklist item	1 = Within client tolerance	2 = Within acceptable tolerance	3 = Within edge case tolerance	4 = Failing tolerance
acceptable; substantive AI task tools are not automatically allowed. Follow the detailed AI guidance and escalate unclear cases.				
16. [Manual] The recording is free of personal information (PII), both on screen and in the audio. Check app account corners (Office, Google, browser profile), Finder and save-dialog paths, and the last few minutes. See the PII and Royalty-free Issues tab for real examples that slipped through.	Yes	N/A	N/A	No
17. [Manual] Deliverable assets meet the applicable licensing requirements. Apply the PII and Copyright Issues guidance, including public-repository exceptions; merely browsing a website with a trademarked logo does not fail.	Yes	N/A	N/A	No
18. [Manual] The narration and everything on screen are free of profanity.	Yes	Minor profanity on screen, not typed by the writer	N/A	Profanity said or typed by the writer, or major on-screen profanity

Checklist item	1 = Within client tolerance	2 = Within acceptable tolerance	3 = Within edge case tolerance	4 = Failing tolerance
19. [Manual] Task is recorded in English and all task materials are in English	Yes	N/A	N/A	No/Cannot verify
20. [Manual] Recording includes an epilogue narration (a narrated summary of how the task was verified, the approach, challenges, quality, and reflections) of 4 minutes or less, before stopping recording (only for ideas originally approved at or after Oct 19, 2026 6PM PT). Target 3-4 minutes with no 3-minute minimum. All duration bands over 4:00 exceed the maximum; they record severity, not an allowance for extra duration. Additional unscored response: "Missing epilogue — does not block approval." Use this dedicated response for a missing epilogue rather than N/A; it must not count as a numeric failure. Do not fail, send back, or require re-recording solely because an epilogue is missing, regardless of idea approval date.	Yes	No, narration length is between 4:01-4:30 mins (exceeds the 4:00 maximum)	No, the narration lacked detail / length is between 4:31+ mins (exceeds the 4:00 maximum)	N/A

Section 3 · Automated coverage

- Two AutoQC modules run on every task in both production worlds — Odin upload checks and Odin narration checks. Between them they cover items 1 to 12.

- Two further modules exist but are switched off: Odin recording shows task check and Odin Eyes Closed check. Items 4 and 5 are still covered, by checks inside the two live modules.
- Because items 1 to 12 are flagged for manual re-checking, a green automated result is not a band 1 on its own.

Automated coverage	Covers
Automated — Odin upload checks and Odin narration checks (re-check by hand)	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11
No automated coverage	12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20

Gap: items 13 to 21 have no automated coverage, including every content-safety item (16 PII, 17 copyright, 18 profanity) and the expertise item (21). If audit volume drops, nothing else catches those. The modules also flag things no checklist item covers — restricted apps, mouse idle over 45 s, and whether the narration is followable at normal speed. Raise those in your comment rather than as a band.

Verdict

One item at band 4 sends the task back. Band 3 does not count — items at 2 or 3 are within tolerance and are feedback only. Three items never fail on their own: a missing epilogue (item 20), complexity on a resubmission (item 21), and a minor AutoQC advice flag.

Items scored 2 or 3 are within tolerance by the guidelines' own wording. They are feedback, not a failure.

Feedback

Paste template

```
Audit — <your name> — <date>
Items at band 4: <list, or none>
Item <n> — band <1-4> — <timestamp> — <what happens on screen>
Why it matters: <the tolerance criterion it missed>
To fix: <what the writer should do differently>
```

Worked example

❌ **Too vague to act on**

“Narration is weak and there’s too much dead air. Sending it back.”

✅ Specific, sourced, actionable

Audit — R. Mensah — 20 Oct 2026

Items at band 4: 11, 4

Item 11 — band 4 — 12:04–13:20. The recording is silent for 76 seconds while a build runs. Band 4 is “over 60 s”.

Item 4 — band 4 — 06:41, 09:15 and 14:02. The narration says “now I change this value here” without naming the field or the value. With eyes closed those steps cannot be followed, and well under 70% of actions carry 2 of the 3 Ws.

Why it matters: the narration has to teach someone who cannot see the screen, and a silence longer than 60 seconds leaves them with nothing to follow.

To fix: name the field and the value every time you change something, and narrate what you are waiting for during a long-running step instead of going quiet.

🏅 Bad Example 🏅

Use the Bad Example to study Project Odin quality guideline violations.

1. Data Science and Analytics

Task Description

As a data scientist who is compiling information to help guide decision making for the upcoming state election in Victoria, I have been tasked with presenting specific demographic data to decision makers. As part of this I need to prefer data for age demogramphics for a regional town area (Ararat, VIC) against overall state averages to be used in a future presentation.

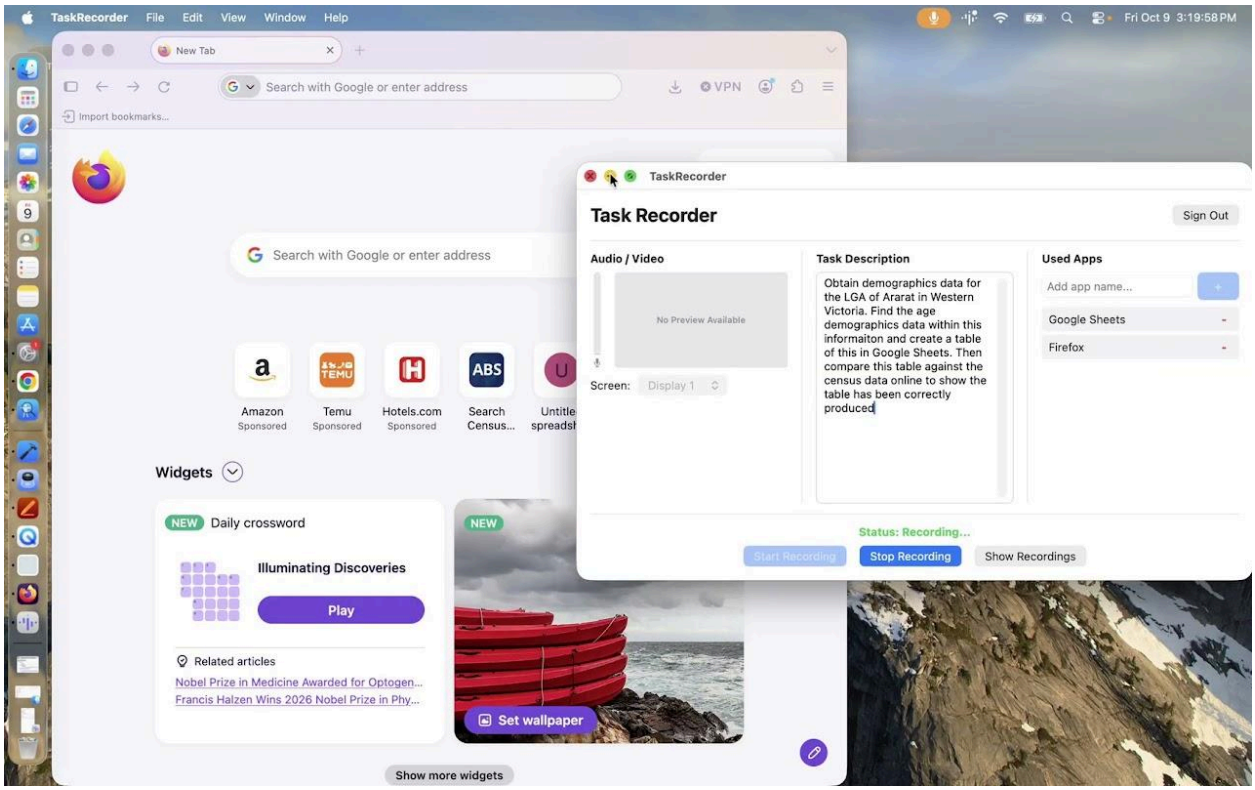
I will use Firefox to obtain the data for the publicly available census 2026 data that can be commercial planning, market research, and strategy and download as a CSV file. I will then load the data into Google Sheets to analyse the data and create a plot of the data in a comparison format between the community and state. I will then print the data to pdf to be used as required, and open it in preview to show that the print worked.

Apps Used

Firefox

Google Sheets

Video: Full task recording (16:41)



Checklist item	1 = Within client tolerance	2 = Within acceptable tolerance	3 = Within edge case tolerance	4 = Failing tolerance
[Manual] Metadata.rtf apps listed match the apps listed in Studio	Yes			
[Manual] The menu bar clock shows seconds.	Yes			
[Manual] The Dock is visible at the start and end of the recording.	Yes			
[Manual] The Dock is on the left or right side of the screen, not the bottom.	Yes			
[Manual] The Accessibility Inspector icon is in the Dock with a dot under it, which means the app is running.	Yes			
[Manual] The Accessibility Inspector window stays hidden during the recording.	Yes			
[Manual] The TaskRecorder window only appears when starting or stopping the recording.	Yes			
[Manual] The TaskRecorder window shows the correct task description and apps.	Yes			
[Manual] The task description document is shown at the start of the recording.				No
[Manual] Filling out Metadata.rtf is absent in the recording.	Yes			
[Manual] The recording is free of disallowed AI use. Ordinary incidental enhancement may be acceptable; substantive AI task tools are not automatically allowed. Follow the detailed AI guidance and escalate unclear cases.	Yes			
[Manual] The recording is free of personal information (PII), both on screen and in the audio.	Yes			
[Manual] No Mercor, Odin, Studio or other project information is shown on screen.	Yes			
[Manual] Deliverable assets meet the applicable licensing requirements. Apply the PII and Copyright Issues guidance, including public-repository exceptions; merely browsing a website with a trademarked logo does not fail.	Yes			
[Manual] The narration and everything on screen are free of profanity and explicit content.	Yes			

[Manual] Narration speed (not a requirement; use the eyes-closed test instead).	Not scored			
[Manual] Each pause in narration lasts 45 seconds or less.	Yes			
[Manual] The narration audio is clear, with no background noise making it hard to hear. (Exception: loud typing is fine as long as it does not make narration unclear.)	0%			
[Manual] The task follows the current banned-app, limited-use and app-specific rules; unrestricted apps need no prior approval.				No
[Manual] Typing takes up 25% of the video or less (35% or less for Coding / Content & Writing tasks).	Yes, ≤20% of task			
[Manual] The video shows professional-level skill in the domain, meaning it isn't something anyone could do.	Yes			
[Manual] The writer pauses for at least 1 second after each mouse click.				No, missing in 11+ segments
[Manual] Task checklist and PII confirmation were truthfully completed by the writer				No
[Manual] At least 1 UI element has been changed from the default Mac setup	Yes			
[Manual] Task is recorded in English	Yes			

What makes a good vs. a bad task

✅ Good task	❌ Bad task
Has a clear goal, every app's use, professionally usable deliverables and steps to verify their outcome that shows the writer's professional domain expertise.	Has repetitive steps that add nothing to the workflow.
Has no set-up issues (menubar is visible with the seconds, accessibility inspector has a dot underneath it and TaskRecorder is prefilled with the goal and the task apps)	Set-up is incomplete/absent
Task length is within the 15 minute and 54:59 minute threshold	Task length is either lower than the 15 minute threshold or over the 54:59 minute threshold
Does not contain any PII	Contains details like personal emails, contact information, name or addresses.
Does not use any restricted apps.	Uses restricted apps.
No AI accessed during the task	The writer uses AI during their recording/ interacts with AI prompts such as 'Ask me anything'.
Has all the 4 files including the Metadata.rtf file, video.mp4 file, recording_TIMESTAMP.zip and the deliverables.zip	Is missing one or all the files required to review the task.
The deliverables.zip contains all the files including the input file, artifacts and final outputs.	The deliverables.zip contains is missing the final output
Dock is positioned to the left or right of the screen	Dock is positioned at the bottom of the screen.
Has at least one UI element changed apart from the position of the dock, such as the wallpaper, resolution, the mode or the colour of the icons.	No UI change apart from the position of the dock.
Working windows remain readable and unnecessary overlaps are minimized.	Overlapping or obscured task windows should be recorded as qualitative delivery callouts, not a standalone reason for rejection.

✅ Good task	❌ Bad task
The cursor naturally guides the viewer. The closing epilogue may be still.	Observed mouse inactivity is recorded as a qualitative delivery callout, not a grade or standalone rejection.
Typing is ≤25% for a non-coding and non-Content & Writing task and ≤35% for a Coding / Content & Writing task	epiTyping is >25% for a non-coding and non-Content & Writing task and >35% for a Coding / Content & Writing task
At least 70% of counted interactions name the specific element and where it is on screen; WHAT makes the action understandable. No stretch of 60 seconds or more of interactions is unnarrated.	Fewer than 70% of counted interactions name the specific element and where it is on screen. Vague words such as ‘this’ and ‘here’ do not identify the element or its location.
Metadata.rtf file is hidden throughout the task and does not appear in the recording.	Metadata.rtf file is not hidden throughout the task and appears in the recording.
No Mercor, Odin, Studio or other project information on screen.	Mercor, Odin, Studio or other project information is visible on screen.

🏅 Golden Examples 🏅

Use the Golden Examples to study professional workflow and narration standards.

---

1. Finance
2. Design
3. Audio & Music
4. Animation & VFX
5. Software & AI/ML Engineering

---

1. Finance

Task Description

I am an Account Receivable personnel at a company in the UK and have been tasked with adding a new vendor to our ERP system and creating a Purchase Order (PO) tracking workflow for our Accounting team to manage POs better. I will begin by adding missing information onto a sample PO on the Pages app, then transfer the vendor details, and PO line items onto our ERP system on Microsoft Dynamics 365 Business Central, and finally create a PO tracking workflow on Monday.com. I will verify the flow is complete by running the same at the end of its creation and check if the status updates as per the trigger, and deliver the final PO raised on Microsoft Dynamics 365 Business Central and the PO workflow from Monday.com to my team.

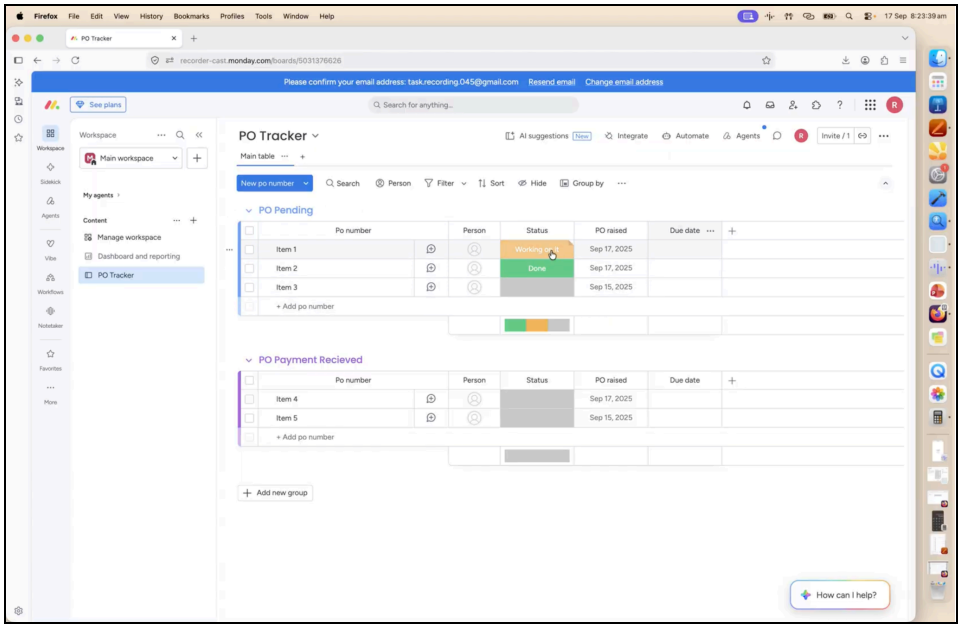
Apps Used

Monday.com

Microsoft Dynamics 365 Business Central

Pages

Video: Full task recording (44:19)


PO Tracker
Please confirm your email address: task.recording.045@gmail.com Resend email Change email address
See plans
Search for anything...
Workspace
Main workspace
My agents
Content
Manage workspace
Dashboard and reporting
PO Tracker
PO Tracker
AI suggestions
Integrate
Automate
Agents
Invite / 1
Main table
New po number
Search
Person
Filter
Sort
Hide
Group by
PO Pending
Po number
Person
Status
PO raised
Due date
Item 1
Working on it
Sep 17, 2025
Item 2
Done
Sep 17, 2025
Item 3
Sep 15, 2025
+ Add po number
PO Payment Recieved
Po number
Person
Status
PO raised
Due date
Item 4
Sep 17, 2025
Item 5
Sep 15, 2025
+ Add po number
Add new group
How can I help?

2. Design

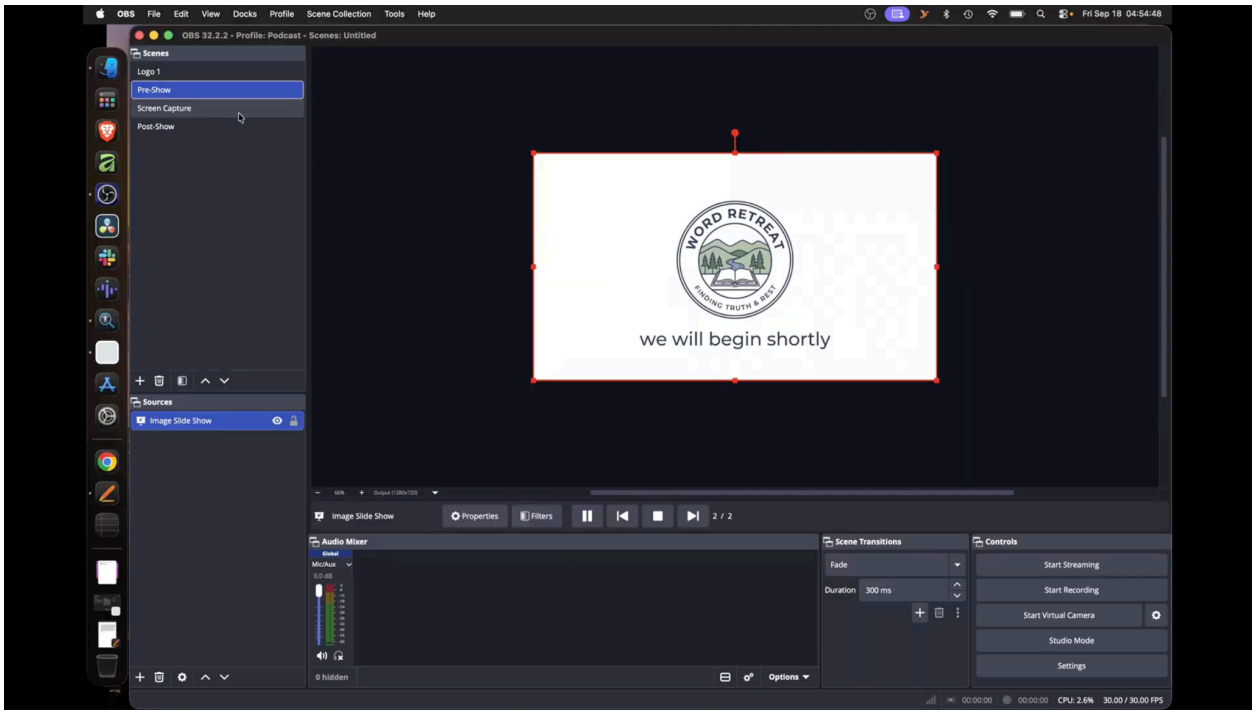
Task Description

I am a Content Creator preparing aspects of a new podcast. Using OBS Studio, I will setup different scenes for different aspects of the podcast such as pre-show and screen-share, which will involve the import of some images. The final deliverables will be the export of the scenes created in OBS.

Apps Used

OBS Studio

Video: Full task recording (24:44)



3. Audio & Music

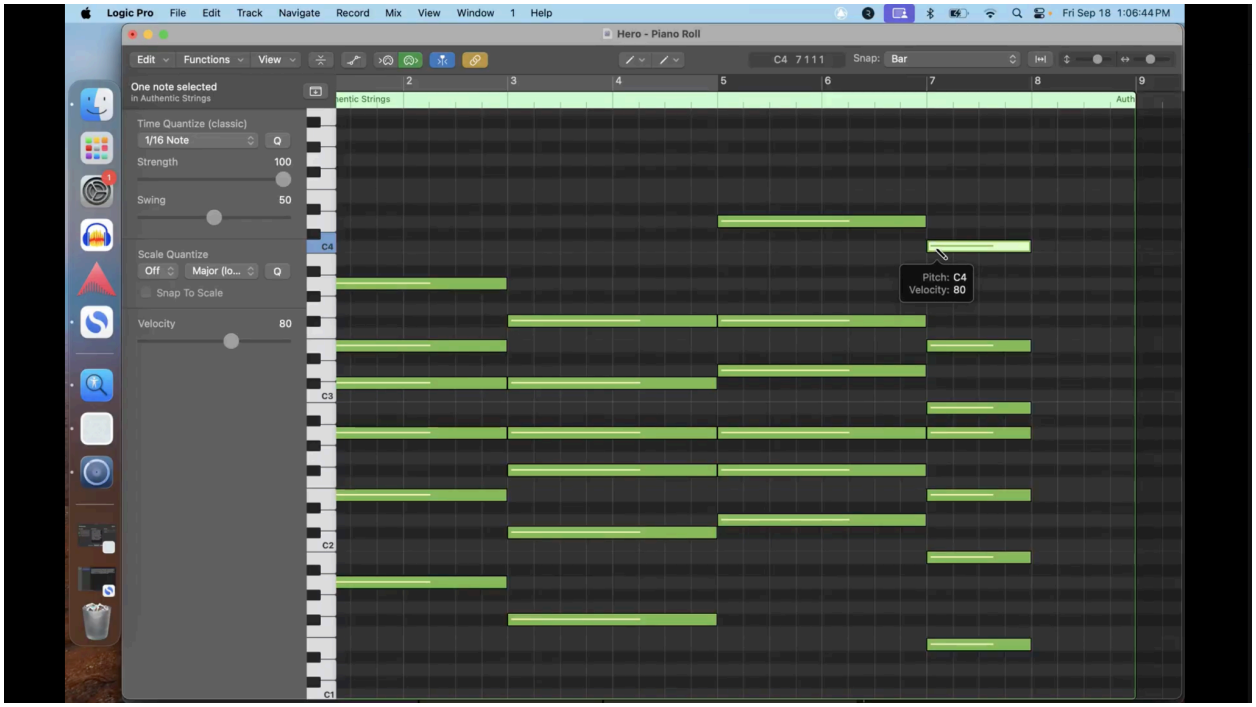
Task Description

I am a film score composer and I'm working on the underlying theme for a heroic end credit sequence. I will use Logic Pro in the second phase (P2) of the execution to compose a string accompaniment for the piano top melody created in phase one (PI). I will also establish a chordal sequence (I - vi - IV - V) to define the passage. The final deliverable will be a stereo export of the complete Logic Pro session.

Apps Used

Logic Pro

Video: Full task recording (22:58)



4. Animation & VFX

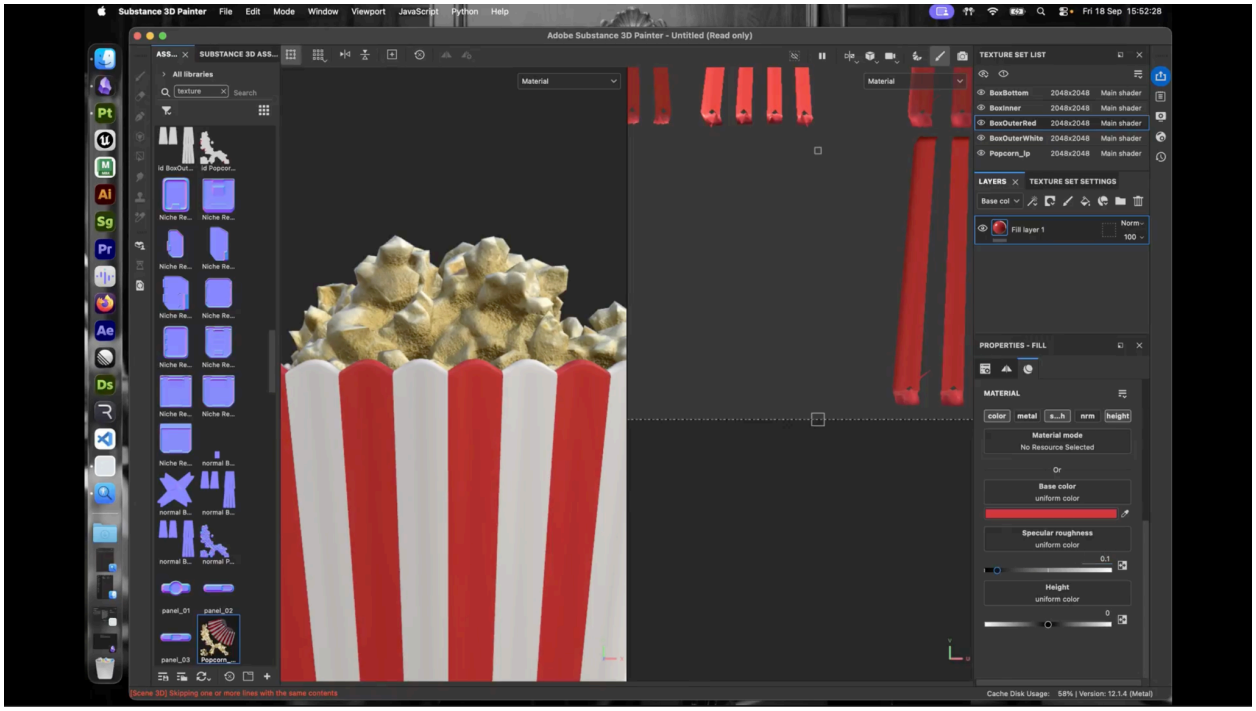
Task Description

You are a 3D Modeler tasked with cleaning up the textures of a photogrammetry model for use in Unreal Engine. Use Adobe Substance 3D Painter to bake the provided high poly model onto the provided low poly model, apply the provided photogrammetry diffuse texture, clean up artifacts on the texture, add a powdery finish to the popcorn and add red and white striped packaging textures to the popcorn box. Export the texture maps appropriate for use in Unreal Engine.

Apps Used

Substance 3D Painter

Video: Full task recording (40:59)



5. Software & AI/ML Engineering

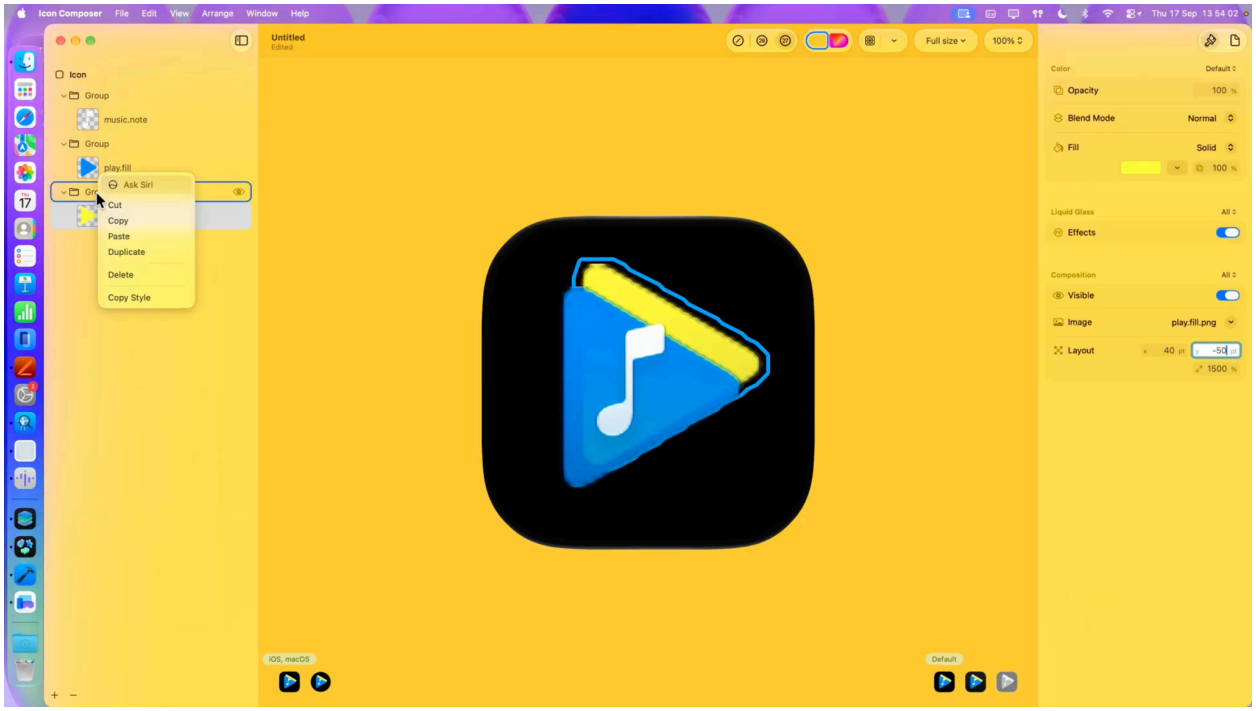
Task Description

As an iOS app developer I want to create a distinctive visual identity for a simple Music Player app. Use SF Symbols as independent visual components, and compose them as separate layers in Icon Composer. Build & refine the multi-layered icon in Icon Composer and integrate the resulting icon into a SwiftUI Music Player app in Xcode. Deliver the layered icon and Xcode project; verify that the app builds successfully and the icon is correctly integrated.

Apps Used

Device Hub
Xcode
SF Symbols
Icon Composer

Video: Full task recording (28:37)



Odin Reviewer Playbook: Faster Reviews

Target: average review time under 45 minutes per task, with the same quality bar. AHT is looked at together with your QC pass rate, so speed only counts if your approvals hold up.

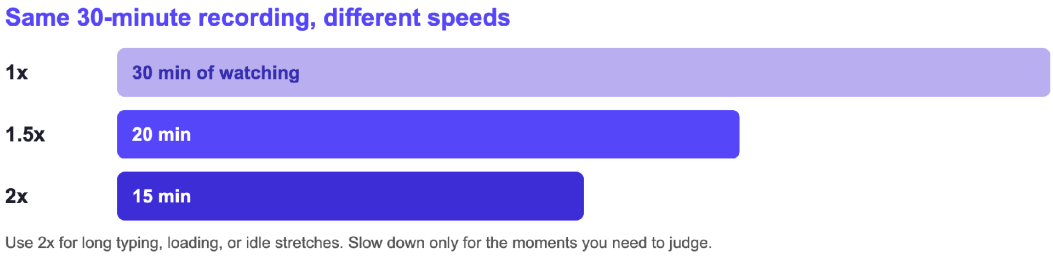
The 30-second version

1. Watch at **1.5x or faster** with live captions on.
2. Check **every AutoQC flag**: confirm the real ones, dismiss the false ones.
3. Spend your watch time on what AutoQC misses, **narration first**.
4. Found a critical issue? Take **~10 more minutes** to catch other critical issues, then send back with the template.
5. Minor issue you can fix yourself? **Fix it and approve.**

What's in this guide

- 1) Quick Wins
- 2) The Efficient Review Flow
- 3) What AutoQC Misses
- 4) Quick Send-Backs
- 5) Fix and Approve vs Send Back
- 6) Re-reviews
- 7) Habits That Slow You Down

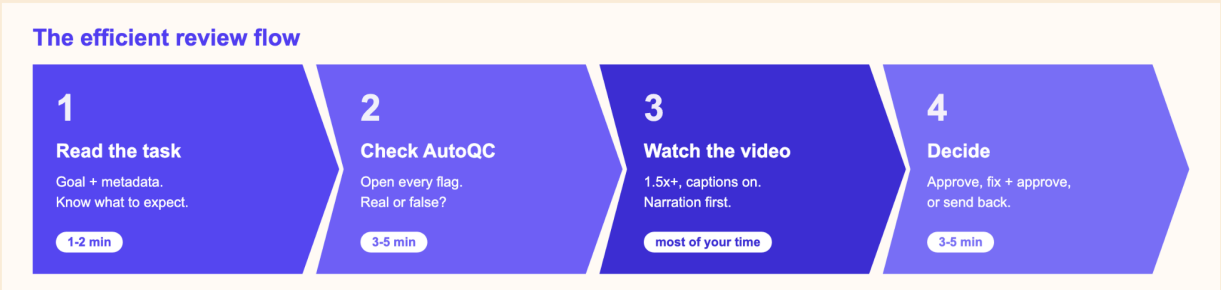
1) Quick Wins



- **Watch at 1.5x or faster.** Go to 2x through long typing, loading, or idle stretches, and skip ahead when nothing new is happening on screen.
- **Turn on live captions** (Chrome Live Caption or macOS Live Captions). Reading the narration while you watch makes the narration check much faster.
- **Start loading the video as soon as you claim the task.** Do the Goal and metadata check while it buffers.

- **Clear "My re-reviews" first**, then work the Prioritized Review Queue from the top. See the Re-reviews section for more details.
- **Jump to timestamps, don't rewatch.** Use AutoQC flag timestamps to go straight to the moment in question.
- **Keep feedback short.** One line per issue with a timestamp and the fix. Use the send-back template in Section 4.

2) The Efficient Review Flow



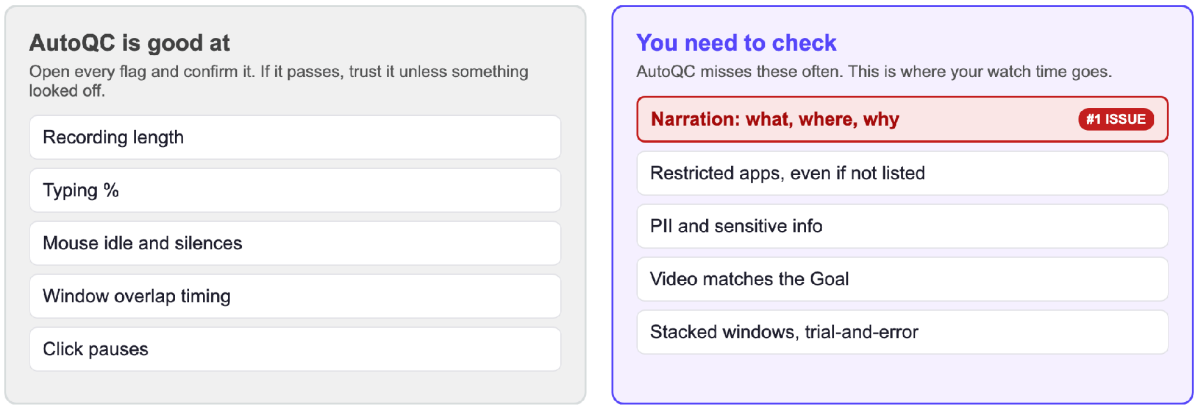
In step 3, focus on the checks in Section 3: What AutoQC Misses.

Step 2 in detail: checking AutoQC flags

- Open **every** flag, major and minor, jump to its timestamp, and decide if it is real.
- **Real flag:** treat it like any issue you found yourself (Sections 4 and 5).
- **False flag:** dismiss it and move on. Common false flags: mouse idle while the writer is typing, "no narration found" on videos with audible narration, and the TaskRecorder window flagged for a split second.
- If AutoQC passes something, please recheck it if it's on the reviewer checklist. If it is on "**AutoQC checks of task elements (for reference purpose):**", you don't need to recheck it unless something on screen looked off.

3) What AutoQC Misses

Who checks what

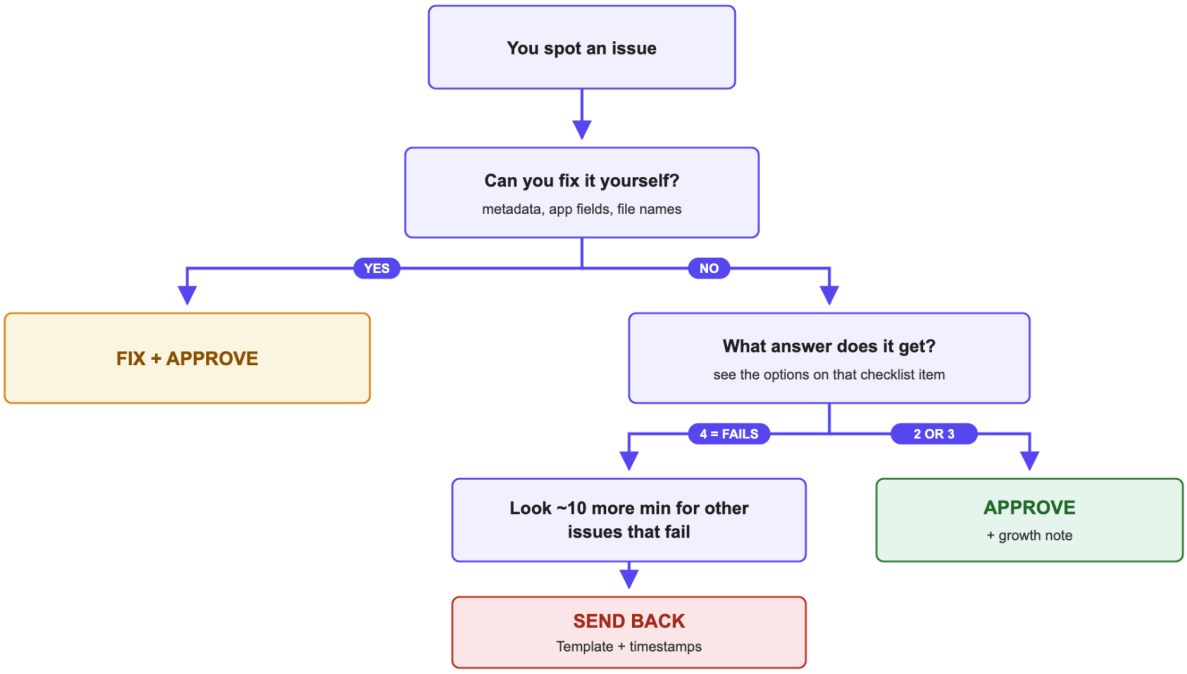


Narration is by far the most common quality issue. It is the top reason writers get sent back, and the top issue QC finds in tasks reviewers approved. Give it most of your attention.

- **Narration:** does it explain what is happening, where on screen, and why? Would it pass the eyes-closed test (could you follow along without seeing the screen)? Watch for vague words like "this", "that", "here".
- **Restricted apps:** check every app that appears on screen against the Restricted Apps list, even ones opened for a few seconds. A frequent miss: the writer uses a restricted app but doesn't list it in Studio, or even in TaskRecorder, so it only shows up in the video.
- **PII and sensitive info:** personal email addresses, account details, addresses, financial or private data on screen.
- **Video matches the Goal:** the writer actually completes the task described.
- **Stacked windows and trial-and-error:** windows fully covered by another window, or fumbling that makes the workflow hard to follow.

4) Quick Send-Backs

Found an issue? What to do



FOR REVIEWERS ONLY: If you confirm a checklist fail, **you don't need to finish the full review.** Spend **about 10 more minutes** scanning for other critical issues (especially the common ones in Section 3), so the writer can fix everything in one re-record. Then send back using the template.

Send-back template (paste into Reviewer Comments for quick reviews)

> Hi! Sending this back so you can fix the following:
> • **[Issue]** at **[timestamp]**: [what to change]
> • **[Issue]** at **[timestamp]**: [what to change]
>
> Thank you for your hard work!

5) Fix and Approve vs Send Back

A send-back costs the writer a re-record and costs you a second review. If you can fix it yourself, or it is minor, **fix it, leave a growth note, and approve.**

Issue	Action	How
Metadata.rtf errors (Request wording, topology, small mismatches with the Goal)	**FIX + APPROVE**	Fix it yourself. Never send back for metadata alone.
Metadata.rtf and TaskRecorder text describe the same task but aren't word-for-word identical	**FIX + APPROVE**	Fix the metadata.rtf file
A non-restricted app was used but not listed, or a listed app wasn't used	**FIX + APPROVE**	Update the app fields and files so they match the video.
Deliverable file name is slightly off	**FIX + APPROVE**	Rename the file yourself.
A restricted app appears in the video, listed or not	**SEND BACK**	See Section 4.
Desktop setup missed (clock, Accessibility Inspector, no change from a standard Mac)	**SEND BACK**	See Section 4.
Brief glimpse of "Mercor", "Odin", a project folder, or a non-sensitive item	**APPROVE**	No note needed.
Intro >20s but <2 minutes	**APPROVE**	Growth note.
Window overlap between 6 and 30 seconds as the only issue	**APPROVE**	Growth note.
Short idle or silent stretches within their nonblocking tolerance bands; pauses after clicks under 1 second. This approval allowance does not apply to typing over the limit: typing fails above 25% of the recording, or above 35% for Coding / Content & Writing. Exactly 25% or 35%, respectively, does not fail.	**APPROVE**	Growth note.

6) Re-reviews

Re-reviews should be much faster. You already know the task, and the writer has fixed your notes, so there is usually less to flag and less to write.

- **Only files changed?** Check the items from the last send-back and the new AutoQC result. No need to rewatch the whole video.
- **Re-recorded?** Watch it, but focus on the issues you flagged last time and the Section 3 checks.
- **Resubmitted with no changes?** Send back quickly, pointing to the original note.

7) Habits That Slow You Down

- Watching at 1x from start to finish.
- Watching to the end after you've already confirmed a critical issue.
- Sending back for a minor issue you could fix yourself.
- Writing long feedback instead of more pointed bullets that are easier for the writer understand.

Questions or edge cases: post in the #odin-reviewers-hub channel with the task link.

Odin Reviewer DM Templates

How to use

Every DM is built from three parts:

- Header
- Opener (sections 2–5)
- One snippet per item that did not score 1 (sections 6–7).
    - The lowest score on the checklist decides which opener you use.

Header line for every DM:

```
None
MM/DD @ HH:MM TIMEZONE, Review #___, REVIEWER NAME
```

Writing rules for every snippet:

- Give a timestamp (MM:SS) for anything seen in the video.
- Say what was wrong, why the client needs it, and what to do next time.
- Use the current status names: Needs Edits and Rejected (not "Needs Revision").
- Point to the Writer Guidelines section by name when it helps.

Approved (all items at 1)

Use when every manual item and every AutoQC card passes. Delete any line that does not apply to this task.

```
None
MM/DD @ HH:MM TIMEZONE, Review #___, REVIEWER NAME
Comments: Task approved. Clear, well-paced recording narrated with
What, Where and Why. Setup verified: menu bar clock shows seconds,
Dock visible on the left/right at start and end, Accessibility
Inspector running with its window hidden, at least one UI element
changed. TaskRecorder shown only at start and stop, with the
```

```
correct Goal and apps. Goal document shown and intro no longer than
60 seconds (21–60 seconds is an edge case). Metadata.rtf matches
Studio (apps, workflow) and was not shown in the recording. Current
banned-app, limited-use and app-specific rules followed;
unrestricted apps need no prior approval; no disallowed AI use,
PII, or licensing/profanity violations after applying the
documented exceptions. Project information alone does not block
approval. Good window management, deliberate clicks, and typing
within limits. Video length, screenshot count, recording ZIP,
video.mp4 and deliverables.zip verified. Professional-level work
with a complete final deliverable.
```

Approved with growth notes (worst item at 2 or 3)

Use when the task passes, but one or more items scored 2 or 3. Paste the matching snippets from section 6 under "Areas to grow".

```
None
MM/DD @ HH:MM TIMEZONE, Review #___, REVIEWER NAME
Hi ___,

I've approved task ___. You did a strong job on ___.

Areas to grow for your next tasks:
- [paste snippet]
- [paste snippet]

None of these blocked approval this time, but items at the edge of
tolerance can fail on a future task. The Workflow Checklist in the
Writer Guidelines covers each one. Keep up the great work!
```

Needs Edits (any item at 4)

Use when at least one item fails, but the task can still be fixed within its approved idea. Split fixes into what needs a re-record and what only needs files or metadata corrected, so the writer knows the size of the job.

None

```
MM/DD @ HH:MM TIMEZONE, Review #___, REVIEWER NAME
Hi ___,

I've completed my review of task ___. You did a good job on ___,
but the items below need to be fixed before I can approve it.

Requires a re-record:
- [paste snippet]

Requires a file or metadata fix only:
- [paste snippet]

Growth notes (did not block approval):
- [paste snippet]

Please run both AutoQC checks again before resubmitting, and use
the Workflow Checklist in the Writer Guidelines. Once these are
addressed, the next version should be ready to approve. I look
forward to seeing it!
```

Item-by-item snippets

Setup and TaskRecorder

Metadata.rtf corrected by reviewer — file fix; do not send back for metadata alone

Menu bar clock shows seconds — 4

Dock visible at start and end — 4

Dock on left or right — 4

Accessibility Inspector running (dot under Dock icon) — 4

Accessibility Inspector window hidden — 4

TaskRecorder window only at start and stop — 4

TaskRecorder shows the correct task description and apps — 4

Task description document shown at start — 4

Intro: 21–90 seconds is an edge case; over 90 seconds fails

At least 1 UI element changed — 4

Recorded in English, all materials in English — 4

Content and compliance

Free of disallowed AI use — Ordinary incidental enhancement may be acceptable; substantive AI task tools are not automatically allowed. Follow the detailed AI guidance and escalate unclear cases.

Free of PII (screen and audio) — 4

Project information alone — nonblocking; assess PII separately

Deliverable assets meet licensing requirements — apply documented exceptions

Profanity — apply the minor on-screen exception; explicit content assessed separately

Follows restricted-app and limited-use rules; no approval needed for unrestricted apps: 4

Performance

Easy to follow at 1x speed

Each narration pause 45 seconds or less

Narration audio clear (loud typing OK if narration stays clear)

Typing 25% or less (35% or less for Coding / Content & Writing)

Pauses at least 1 second after each mouse click

Setup and TaskRecorder

Metadata.rtf corrected by reviewer — file fix; do not send back for metadata alone

None

```
Metadata.rtf - I corrected Metadata.rtf to match the task and
re-uploaded it. No writer action is needed for this metadata
correction. Reviewer: use this message only after making and
verifying the correction; do not send back for metadata alone.
```

Menu bar clock shows seconds — 4

None

```
Clock seconds - The menu bar clock doesn't show seconds [or:
couldn't be verified at MM:SS]. Go to System Settings > Menu Bar >
Clock Options and turn on "Display the time with seconds," then
re-record.
```

Dock visible at start and end — 4

None

```
Dock visibility - The Dock was not visible at the beginning or end
of the recording. Please keep the Dock visible at the beginning and
end. It does not need to remain visible throughout the recording.
```

Dock on left or right — 4

None

```
Dock position - The Dock is at the bottom of the screen. Please
move it to the left or right in System Settings > Desktop & Dock
before re-recording.
```

Accessibility Inspector running (dot under Dock icon) — 4

None

```
Accessibility Inspector - Accessibility Inspector wasn't running during the recording (no dot under its Dock icon). TaskRecorder needs it running for the whole recording to capture the required data. Open it from Xcode > Open Developer Tool, close only its window with the red button, and confirm the dot stays under its icon.
```

Accessibility Inspector window hidden — 4

None

```
Accessibility Inspector window - The Accessibility Inspector window was visible at MM:SS. Close its window with the red button before recording (don't minimize or quit the app) so it keeps running in the background.
```

TaskRecorder window only at start and stop — 4

None

```
TaskRecorder window - The TaskRecorder window was open at MM:SS. Please minimize it right after clicking Start Recording and only bring it back when you're ready to click Stop Recording.
```

TaskRecorder shows the correct task description and apps — 4

None

```
TaskRecorder fields - The TaskRecorder Task Description/Used Apps didn't match the approved task description. Before clicking Start Recording, paste only the approved Goal, exactly as written, and list every app used. Check for leftover details from your previous task.
```

Task description document shown at start — 4

None

```
Opening Task Description Document - The Goal document wasn't shown at the start of the recording. After starting, minimize TaskRecorder so the Goal document is visible, say the intro sentence, then minimize the document. Use Word, Google Docs or another allowed app (not Notes or TextEdit), and show only the Goal, not the Approval ID.
```

Filling out Metadata.rtf absent from recording — 4

None

```
Metadata.rtf visible - Metadata.rtf was [open/being filled out] at MM:SS. Please complete Metadata.rtf before recording and keep it closed during the recording.
```

At least 1 UI element changed — 4

None

```
UI diversity - The desktop uses the default Mac setup. Please change at least one UI element before recording, such as the wallpaper, light/dark mode, Dock size or resolution.
```

Recorded in English, all materials in English — 4

None

```
Language - [The narration / the file ___ / the app interface] was not in English at MM:SS. All narration and task materials must be in English, and the system language must stay set to English.
```

Content and compliance

Free of disallowed AI use — Ordinary incidental enhancement may be acceptable; substantive AI task tools are not automatically allowed. Follow the detailed AI guidance and escalate unclear cases.

None

```
AI use - [Tool/feature] was used to [prompt / generate / summarize] at MM:SS. No AI interaction is allowed during recording, including Google AI Overview's "Ask anything" and AI Mode. Inputs may be prepared with Gemini before recording, with "AI-generated before recording" selected in Studio.
```

Free of PII (screen and audio) — 4

None

```
PII - ___ was [shown on screen / said aloud] at MM:SS. Please re-record without any private personal identifiable information, including names, emails, phone numbers, addresses, account details, biometrics, and Mac Addresses. TaskRecorder 2.4.4 requires no sign-in. Use your assigned mercor.expert email for app logins when required.
```

Project information alone — nonblocking; assess PII separately

None

```
Project information - A project reference was visible at MM:SS. Project information alone does not block approval. Continue checking independently for PII and other blocking issues.
```

Deliverable assets meet licensing requirements — apply documented exceptions

None

```
Copyright - ___ included in deliverables.zip at MM:SS does not meet the applicable licensing requirement: ___. Apply the
```

```
asset-licensing requirement to material included in
deliverables.zip. Browsing a website with a trademarked logo is
acceptable. Apply the public-repository licensing exceptions in the
PII and Copyright Issues guidance. For assets subject to the
CC0/public-domain rule, verify the source terms; a search filter
alone is not enough. Gemini-generated inputs prepared before
recording are allowed. Escalate unclear licensing before deciding.
```

Profanity — apply the minor on-screen exception; explicit content assessed separately

None

```
Profanity - Minor on-screen profanity not typed by the writer is
option 2 and does not block approval. Profanity said or typed by
the writer, or more than minor on-screen profanity, is option 4.
For an option-4 failure: [Profanity was said / profanity was typed
/ more than minor on-screen profanity was shown] at MM:SS; please
re-record without it. Explicit content is assessed separately: if
explicit content was shown at MM:SS, re-record without it.
```

Follows restricted-app and limited-use rules; no approval needed for unrestricted apps: 4

None

```
App-policy issue: ___ was [opened / shown / used] at MM:SS and
conflicts with this current banned-app or limited-use condition:
___. Check https://odin-mercor1.vercel.app/validated-apps and the
in-flight protections before requesting changes. An unlisted app or
missing prior app approval is not a failure by itself.
```

Shows professional-level skill — 4

None

```
Professional expertise - The work in this task could be completed
by someone without domain expertise. For example, ___ at MM:SS is a
```

basic action repeated without professional reasoning. Please show the methods, standards, decisions and checks you'd use as a professional, and explain why you make each choice.

Task checklist and PII confirmation completed truthfully — 4

None

Submission checklist - The checklist/PII confirmation was marked complete, but ___ (MM:SS) does not meet that item. Please open the checklist and PII guidelines and verify each item against your recording before checking the box.

Performance

Easy to follow at 1x speed

Score 2 (a few areas rushed):

```
None
Pacing - A few spots felt rushed (MM:SS, MM:SS). For future tasks, slow down at those moments: move, pause, point, then act, so viewers can follow at normal speed.
```

Score 3 (some parts rushed):

```
None
Pacing - Several parts felt rushed (MM:SS, MM:SS, MM:SS), which is at the edge of what we can accept. Please work at a natural pace, let each action finish before the next one, and keep the cursor on what you're describing.
```

Score 4 (most or all rushed):

```
None
Pacing - Most of the recording moved too fast to follow at normal speed (for example MM:SS and MM:SS). Please re-record at a deliberate pace: move, pause, point, then act, and let each result appear before continuing.
```

Each narration pause 45 seconds or less

Score 2 (46–60s):

```
None
Narration gap - There was a __-second silent gap at MM:SS. For future tasks, keep narrating while you work, even during typing or repeated steps, so no gap goes over 45 seconds.
```

Score 3: N/A for silence.

```
None
Silence has no score-3 band. A gap over 60 seconds fails and should use the score-4 template below.
```

Score 4 (over 60s):

```
None
Narration gap - There was a __-second silent gap at MM:SS. This gap exceeds the 60-second failure threshold, so this needs to be re-recorded with continuous narration.
```

Narration audio clear (loud typing OK if narration stays clear)

Score 2 (30–40% of the narration):

```
None
Audio quality - Background noise obscured about __% of the narration (30–40%; e.g., MM:SS). This is option 2 and does not block approval. For future tasks, record in a quieter space or use headphones with a dedicated microphone.
```

Score 3: N/A for background noise.

```
None
Background noise has no score-3 band. Noise obscuring over 40% of the narration fails and should use the score-4 template below.
```

Score 4 (over 40% of the narration):

```
None
Audio quality - Background noise obscured about __% of the narration (over 40%; e.g., MM:SS), exceeding the failure threshold. Please re-record in a quieter space or use headphones with a dedicated microphone. Check the microphone level in TaskRecorder first, and don't switch audio devices during recording.
```

Typing 25% or less (35% or less for Coding / Content & Writing)

```
None
Typing - Typing took up about __% of your __-minute recording, over the limit of 25% (35% for Coding / Content & Writing). Please re-record with a mouse-driven workflow, and keep every typing segment under 45 seconds. If the idea can't be done without heavy typing, this may need a new task idea instead.
```

Pauses at least 1 second after each mouse click

Score 2 (missing in 1–3 segments):

```
None
Click pacing - A few clicks were rushed (MM:SS, MM:SS). For future tasks, pause about one second after each click so the result is captured.
```

Score 3 (missing in 4–10 segments):

```
None
Click pacing - Clicks were rushed in several places (MM:SS, MM:SS, MM:SS), which is at the edge of what we can accept. Please click, wait a second, then continue.
```

Score 4 (missing in 11+ segments):

```
None
Click pacing - Clicks were rushed throughout the recording (for example MM:SS and MM:SS). The client needs about a one-second pause after every click, so please click, wait a second, then continue.
```

AutoQC snippets

Ratings 1 and 2 need no snippet, though a short line for 2 shows the writer their dispute was read. Ratings 3 (disputed, I disagree) and 4 (failed / not run) use the fail snippet; for a 3, start with the dispute line.

Dispute lines:

```
None
AutoQC dispute (agreed) - I reviewed your dispute on the ___ check and agree with you; it did not count against this task.
```

```
None
AutoQC dispute (not agreed) - I reviewed your dispute on the ___ check but confirmed the issue at MM:SS, so it still needs to be fixed:
```

Not run:

```
None
AutoQC not run - The ___ AutoQC wasn't run before submission. Please run both AutoQCs (Files & Recording and Narration) and resolve any blocking findings before resubmitting.
```

[Files and deliverables (file fixes unless the recording itself is bad)]

All four task files uploaded

Task Recorder zip contents complete, screenshots present

video.mp4 opens

Deliverables named correctly

Metadata.rtf matches the Task Recorder goal and apps

Recording

Video length within 15:00 to 54:59

Dock visible at start and end — 4

No app window covers more than 25% of another for over 6s (allowed up to 30s)

Mouse never idle over 45s outside the closing epilogue; the mouse may remain still during the epilogue.

- Major flag (blocks submission): mouse idle for more than 90s at least once, or mouse idle for >45s more than four times. The closing epilogue is exempt from this mouse-idle rule.
- Minor flag, but permissable: mouse idle for 45-90s, one to three times

Writer performance

Narration says What, Where and Why (≥70% on 2 of the 3)

Screen recording shows the workflow described in the task

Files and deliverables

(file fixes unless the recording itself is bad)

All four task files uploaded

None

```
Missing files - ___ is missing from Studio. Each task needs four uploads: video.mp4, deliverables.zip, the TaskRecorder recording_TIMESTAMP.zip, and Metadata.rtf in its own field (not inside deliverables.zip).
```

Task Recorder zip contents complete, screenshots present

None

```
Recording archive - The TaskRecorder zip is [missing files / has only __ screenshots for a __-second video, below 0.5 per second]. This data is required by the client, so the task needs to be re-recorded. Before your next recording, quit unused apps and large browser tabs, keep enough free storage, and run a short test. Don't rename, unzip or edit the original archive.
```

video.mp4 opens

None

```
Video file - video.mp4 [won't open / ends early at MM:SS / is corrupted]. Please check the beginning, middle and end in QuickTime before uploading. If the file is corrupted, the task needs to be re-recorded.
```

Deliverables named correctly

None

```
Deliverable naming - Please name the zip "deliverables.zip" and label files inside it as input 1, artifact 1, final output 1, etc.,
```

keeping the correct extensions. Every input, intermediate artifact and final output needs to be in the zip.

Metadata.rtf matches the task (apps, request, workflow)

None

Metadata.rtf - The [Topology / Request / Task Description] section doesn't match the recording: ___. Topology should list every app visit in order as LOOKUP, CREATE or MODIFY, and Request must match the TaskRecorder Goal exactly.

Recording

Video acceptance length between 15:00 and 54:59

None

```
Video length - Your video is __:__ long, outside the reviewer acceptance range of 15:00 to 54:59 including the intro and epilogue. Please [plan a more complex workflow / simplify the workflow] and re-record, planning for the writer guidance of 15:00 to 50:59.
```

Dock visible at start and end — 4

None

```
Dock visibility - The Dock was not visible at the beginning or end of the recording. Please keep the Dock visible at the beginning and end. It does not need to remain visible throughout the recording.
```

No app window covers more than 25% of another for over 6s (allowed up to 30s)

None

```
Window management - [App 1] covered [App 2] by more than 25% for about __ seconds at MM:SS. Please use one Fill window or place task windows side by side, and minimize windows you aren't using. Avoid Full Screen and small floating windows. Pop-ups within the same app are fine while in use.
```

Mouse never idle over 45s outside the closing epilogue

None

```
Mouse inactivity - The mouse was idle for about __ seconds at MM:SS outside the closing epilogue. Please keep the cursor active as a teaching pointer and keep any single pause under 45 seconds, without artificial movement. Remember typing does not count as mouse activity. The closing epilogue may be still; AutoQC excludes
```

the final 5 minutes from this check. This technical buffer does not increase the 4:00 epilogue maximum.

Writer performance

Narration says What, Where and Why (≥70% on 2 of the 3)

None

Narration - The narration needs to be clear enough that a listener could follow the task without seeing the screen. Your task was missing [What / Where / Why] in several places, for example MM:SS, MM:SS and MM:SS. Name the action, the exact control and its location, and the reason, and avoid vague words like "here" and "this."

Screen recording shows the workflow described in the task

None

Workflow match - The recording doesn't complete the approved Goal: ___ [was skipped / was replaced with ___] at MM:SS. Please record the workflow as approved. If your plan changes materially, submit a change request in Studio before recording.

🖊️ Changelog of Reviewer Guidelines

Date	Details of changes
Oct 22, 2026	🟩 Reviewer guidelines FULLY UPDATED with new details - please read through the entire document and pay close attention to your role's respective checklists
Oct 20, 2026	🟩 Reviewer and QC checklist are now aligned 🟩Reviewer Checklist: every item now states its fail point in option 4. [Automated] items are scored on the same 1–4 ranges as manual items. 🟩 Studio, Airtable, Mercor and Project Odin information (item 17) is now OK in the recording and no longer blocks approval. 🟩 Metadata.rtf (item 1): fails when it is under 80% similar to the TaskRecorder Goal or Studio. 🟩 Window overlap (item 2): 6–30 s = option 2; over 30 s with no clear effort to fix within time = option 4. 🟩 What / Where / Why (item 3): fails when under 70% of actions have at least 2 of the 3 Ws. An action is anything that changes the state of the document. 🟩 Eyes Closed (item 4): 4 or more ambiguous references is edge case. A 2+ minute stretch narrated mostly with "here" and "this" fails. 🟩 NEW Intro length (item 8): 21–60 s is edge case; over 60 s fails. 🟩 Metadata.rtf shown (item 9): up to 10 s is edge case; over 10 s fails. 🟩 Typing (item 10): fails over 25% (over 35% for Coding / Content & Writing). 🟩 Silence (item 11): 46–60 s is edge case; over 60 s fails. 🟩 Background noise (item 12): 30–40% of narration = option 2; option 3 = N/A; over 40% fails (option 4). 🟩 Profanity (item 18): minor on-screen profanity not typed by the writer = option 2 and does not block approval; profanity said or typed by the writer, or more than minor on-screen profanity, fails (option 4). 🟩 Domain expertise (item 23): fails when a non-expert could do more than 10% of the actions.

	🟩 Pace (item 24): 10–15% of the video above 220 WPM is edge case; over 15% fails. 🟩Missing epilogues DO NOT FAIL tasks regardless of approval date
Oct 19, 2026	🟩 Clarified that CC0, public domain, copyright, royalty free issues only apply to information that ends up in the deliverable.zip. Browsing websites with logos doesn't violate our terms. 🟩Clarified that while ideally project information is hidden (e.g., references to Mercor, Project Odin, Studio Instructions), they will be tolerated in small quantities and should not lead to task rejection on its own. 🟩**NEW - Epilogue narration requirements:** All task ideas originally approved at or after **Oct 19, 2026 6PM PT** must include an epilogue narration (target: 3-4 mins; maximum: 4:00; longer epilogues may be sent back) which serves as a brief reflection of the work. See here for more details 🟩Reviewer acceptance is up to 54:59 total, including intro and epilogue. Writer recording guidance remains no more than 50:59; the higher acceptance limit is not a writer target.
Oct 17, 2026	🟩 Clarified Insightful and pay for reviewers who write tasks (Getting Started). Promoted reviewers keep Insightful running and stay hourly while writing; directly hired reviewers do not run Insightful while writing.
Oct 16, 2026	App-policy update (effective 2026-10-16 18:08 PDT): Historical restriction entries below, including the blanket TextEdit ban, are superseded by the canonical three-category app list. TextEdit may be used for metadata.rtf; separate opening-Goal instructions remain unchanged. In-flight work is protected and now-allowed app rejections may be reconsidered subject to other quality checks.
Oct 14, 2026	🟩 Added the following apps to the restricted app list - all tasks submitted before 10/14 5PM PST should be approved if their only failure mode was a restricted app on this list: 1. anatomyapp 2. Autodesk FBX Review 3. Defold 4. drawBook 5. FL Studio / FruitLoops Studio 6. GameMaker

	7. JASP 8. KiCad 9. LTspice 10. Milanote 11. MohrPlotter 12. OpenVSP 13. Penpot 14. qemu-system-aarch64 15. Sticky Notepad 16. Substance 3D Stager 17. TextExpander 18. VMD
Oct 14, 2026	🟩 Added “If the Reviewer raised the complexity issue in R1 and the writer didn’t fix it, then R2 can send back.” 🟩 Added DM templates
Oct 13, 2026	🟩 Added “The goal is to leave 1-2 sentences of feedback” 🟩 Added New Reviewer info: Run Insightful and Device Requirements
Oct 12, 2026	🟩 TextEdit is now fully restricted, including for filling out Metadata.rtf: the restricted app list entry “FOR METADATA.RTF ONLY - TextEdit.app” was changed to “TextEdit.app” (Odin Production Full Workflow world).
Oct 12, 2026	🟩 Full Facelift
Oct 11, 2026	🟩 Added the following apps to the restricted app list (Odin Production Full Workflow world): 1. Adobe Express 3. Google Gemini 4. Google Play 5. Kali Linux 6. Screenshot 7. Splice 8. Steam 9. Trading View 10. WPS Office
Oct 10, 2026	🟩 Added the following apps to the restricted app list (Odin Production Full Workflow world): 1. Adobe Acrobat 2. Adobe After Effects 3. Adobe Illustrator 4. Adobe InDesign 5. Adobe Premiere Pro 6. Antigravity IDE

	7. App Store.app 8. Apple Music Classical 9. Cisco Packet Tracer 10. CleanMyMac X 11. Complete Anatomy 12. Dictionary.app 13. Font Book.app 14. Games.app 15. GoodNotes 16. GraphPad Prism 17. Linear 18. Magnet 19. Maps.app 20. Mendeley 21. Microsoft Intune 22. Microsoft Store 23. Microsoft Support 24. Music.app 25. News.app 26. NVivo 27. Paprika Recipe Manager 28. Parallels Desktop 29. PDFgear 30. Podcasts.app 31. Shazam 32. Siri.app 33. SnapGene 34. Spotify 35. Substance 3D Painter 36. TradingView 37. UCSF Chimera 38. Wolfram Mathematica
Oct 4, 2026	🟩 Added the following apps to the restricted app list (Odin Production Core world): 1. Apple Compressor 2. Apple Motion 3. Final Cut Pro 4. iMovie 5. Keynote 6. Logic Pro 7. MainStage 8. Pages

Reviewer Q&A

Quick answers to your most common questions. Last updated October 22, 2026.

Status and probation (Mercor team is working on fixing these issues)

Q1. How do I know if I passed probation?

Maven sends you the audit result for each review. Pass, and you become a Reviewer with an 80 h/week cap.

Q2. My review matched the final decision. Why did I fail the audit?

Auditors also check that you caught every critical issue, not just the outcome.

Q3. My role went back to Writer, or Studio says "Project not found."

Known sync bug. Access is being restored, and you don't need to redo anything.

Q4. I passed probation, but my role or hour cap didn't update.

We're fixing affected accounts. Not reported yet? Post in #odin-reviewers-hub.

Q5. I don't see any tasks to claim.

Claim reviews from the Prioritized Review Queue in Studio. Queue missing? See Q3. Or you can claim from the normal review queue.

Reviewer screening

Q6. I didn't pass the screening. What now?

You stay a writer or can become a writer if you are a new reviewer. There are no retakes.

Q7. The screening glitched or didn't save.

Post the time you took it and screenshots in #odin-reviewers-hub.

Making the call

Q8. What can I approve with a growth note?

- Silence of 46–60 seconds
- Intro of 21–60 seconds
- Window-management issues (record a qualitative delivery callout, not a grade)
- Metadata.rtf on screen for up to 10 seconds
- 4 or more vague references like "here" or "this"
- Minor on-screen profanity the writer didn't type

Q9. What never blocks approval on its own?

- A missing epilogue
- Mouse inactivity or window overlap (record a delivery callout in Internal Notes, with timestamps)
- A minor AutoQC flag
- Wrong metadata, file names or app list (fix it yourself and approve)

Q10. I found a critical issue. Do I keep watching?

Yes. Complete all checkable review sections and list the issues with timestamps before sending the task back. Do not stop solely because you found a critical issue. If inaccessible or corrupt evidence prevents a check, record what could not be reviewed in Internal Notes and check the remaining available evidence.

Q11. The narration says "click here" a lot but explains What and Where.

Approve with a growth note, unless there's a 2+ minute stretch of "here" and "this."

Q12. Do deliverables need to be in English?

Yes.

Q13. Is an educational software license OK?

If it is not a commercial license then no, send it back. A full license is fine.

Task statuses

Q14. What does RFD mean?

Ready for Delivery: the task has passed every required check and is final for delivery. RFD - Minor is a different status and is not final approval; see Q24.

Pay and time

Q15. How do I get paid?

Through Insightful. Run your timer during active project work. Your efficiency counts toward performance.

Q16. Can I track time for calls like this Q&A?

Yes.

Q17. What are the pay tiers?

- Probation: $40/h, 6 hours total
- Standard: $55/h total, up to 80 h/week. These Standard and Trusted totals take effect October 22, 2026 at 3:00 p.m. PDT.
- Trusted: $75/h total ($55/h base + $20/h bonus), up to 80 h/week (10+ reviews and defect rate under 10%). Existing tier requirements, quality expectations and approved hour limits continue to apply. Contracts show the role's base rate; the Trusted total includes the bonus.

Q18. How is my defect rate calculated?
(defects + 1) ÷ (audits + 10). One defect in your first audit is about 18%.

Q19. What counts toward bonuses?
Recording reviews, re-reviews and probation audits. Not idea reviews.

Known account issues we're fixing

Affected and haven't reported it? Post in #odin-reviewers-hub.

- Role reset to Writer after passing probation
- "Project not found" or missing review queue in Studio
- Role or hour cap not updated after probation
- Probation results not yet shared
- Probation reminders after not passing the screening
- Odin dashboard redirecting to onboarding
- Contract, Studio, dashboard and Maven showing different roles
- Contract still showing pay per task
- No access to project docs or Slack channels
- Requests to move back to the writer role

More questions

Q20. How long do probation audits take?
We aim to have probation audits done within 48 hours of submission but some cases may run longer.

Q21. What happens if I don't pass probation?
If you don’t pass probation then you will be offered a writer contract to remain on the project.

Q22. Are screening scores shared?
Screening scores are not shared in order to keep the answers confidential. You can get feedback from your first few reviews on probation or through reaching out to your review lead / EPM.

Q23. How do I move back to the writer role?
Use the Odin Role Change Request form in the Writer Guide Pay FAQ (Q21) to request a move to Writer. Continue in your current role until the team approves the change and confirms your start date, pay/contract terms, access and handling of unfinished tasks.

Q24. What do RFD – Minor and "Under Quality Review" mean?
Both are quality re-review statuses for tasks that were sent back: RFD - Minor for minor issues and Under Quality Review for larger ones. Neither is final approval, and neither waives any requirement. The re-review checks every requirement again. If the task passes, it moves to Ready for Delivery; if not, it is sent back for fixes or archived. Mouse-inactivity and window-management findings are recorded as delivery callouts, not reasons to send back on their own.

Q25. Do send-backs count toward bonuses?

Yes the bonuses are typically driven by just number of hours logged or number of reviews completed given it's under a certain AHT (average handling time). Send-backs therefore count as we want to drive quality and will be auditing tasks sent back as well as approved to ensure you made the right decision in either direction.

Q26. When will bonuses and Studio data show on the Odin dashboard?

We are currently revamping our dashboard so you all can stay up to date. There is not a set ETA but we will see how quickly we can build it to get you all more visibility.